

The Smithport Landing Site: An Alto Focus
Component in De Soto Parish, Louisiana

CLARENCE H. WEBB

Reprint from BULLETIN OF THE TEXAS ARCHEOLOGICAL SOCIETY,
Vol 34, 1963.

The Smithport Landing Site: An Alto Focus
Component in De Soto Parish, Louisiana

CLARENCE H. WEBB

Reprint from BULLETIN OF THE TEXAS ARCHEOLOGICAL SOCIETY,
Vol 34, 1963.

The Project Gutenberg eBook of The Smithport Landing Site: An Alto Focus Component in De Soto Parish, Louisiana

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: The Smithport Landing Site: An Alto Focus Component in De Soto Parish, Louisiana

Author: Clarence H. Webb

Release date: June 9, 2021 [eBook #65573]

Most recently updated: October 18, 2024

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/65573

Credits: Stephen Hutcheson and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net>

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE
SMITHPORT LANDING SITE: AN ALTO FOCUS COMPONENT IN DE
SOTO PARISH, LOUISIANA ***

The Smithport Landing Site: An Alto Focus Component in De Soto Parish, Louisiana

CLARENCE H. WEBB

Reprint from BULLETIN OF THE TEXAS ARCHEOLOGICAL SOCIETY, Vol. 34, 1963.

143

ABSTRACT

This is a belated description of the Smithport Landing Site, one of several known Alto Focus components in northwestern Louisiana. This large village site, on the western margin of the Red River flood plain, covers portions of several low hills which front on a former lake.

Nineteen pottery vessels, all but two identifiable as Alto Focus types, were found with fourteen burials. Included are *Hickory Fine Engraved*, *Davis Incised*, *Kiam Incised*, *Wilkinson Punctated*, and *Smithport Plain* (virtually identical with *Bowles Creek Plain*) types.

Surface materials comprise 1553 sherds, 61 dart and 55 arrow points, and a modest number of chipped and polished stone tools or ornaments. The stone tool assemblage seems to be basically late Archaic with the addition of small arrow points.

Although the sherds as well as whole vessels are predominantly derived from Alto Focus ceramics, a small percentage of Coles Creek, a somewhat larger representation of Bossier Focus, and a few late Caddoan pottery types are identified. Similarities and differences between the ceramics of this site, the Davis (Alto) Site in eastern Texas, and the central Louisiana sequence of pottery, are pointed out. Possible relationships between Coles Creek, Alto, Bossier, and Plaquemine ceramics are developed. It is postulated that

Caddoan (Alto) and Coles Creek peoples or influences entered northwestern Louisiana almost simultaneously, and that Bossier Focus developed out of the amalgamation of these two previous cultures. A few very late Caddoan sherds indicate a late occupation at Smithport Landing, possibly during historic times.

INTRODUCTION

The Smithport Landing Site was initially explored by Monroe Dodd, Jr., and the author between 1934 and 1940.^[1] It was the first site at which we found burials and whole pottery; it was also the first site in Louisiana which was identified as an Alto Focus component (Webb, 1948) and was recognized as such in the Davis Site report (Newell and Krieger, 1949: 195, 197, Fig. 62). In describing the Bossier Focus, Smithport Landing was one of 15 sites used for comparison and discussion of the relative incidence of Bossier Focus pottery types, and of several pottery complexes. First suggested in my 1948 paper, and elaborated in a more recent study (Webb, 1961) of 20 sites in northwestern Louisiana, is the thesis that the Bossier Focus developed out of a simultaneous spread of Alto and Coles Creek peoples or influences across this area in post-Marksville times. Smithport Landing was one of the key sites in this study, because of the admixture of Alto and Coles Creek pottery types and the presence of a minor Bossier Focus manifestation.

It therefore seems appropriate to publish the available information about this site, despite the limited excavations conducted nearly 30 years ago. The criticism has been made that too many foci in the Caddoan area have been based on excavation of a single site and that the Alto Focus, for example, is based on the Davis Site alone. The information presented herein concerning Smithport Landing and other Alto Focus manifestations in Louisiana was available to, and used by, Krieger as indicated in the Davis report. The details should have been published for other students, however, especially since burials of the Alto period are limited in number.

144

SITE ENVIRONMENT

The Smithport Landing Site is in the eastern edge of De Soto Parish, about eight miles east of Mansfield, the Parish seat ([Fig. 1](#)). It is a relatively large village site situated on eroded and dissected hills which project in an expanded tongue of land fronting on Old Smithport or Clear Lake (Bayou Pierre Lake). The former lake bed is now dry in the summer, swampy during the rainy season. Buffalo Bayou courses through this low area to join the outflow of present Smithport Lake about one mile northeast of the site. Further eastward this drainage flows into Bayou Pierre which continues some 20 miles down the southwestern margin of the Red River flood plain until it empties into this river near Natchitoches.

The hills on which the site is located ([Fig. 2](#)) are 10 to 20 feet above the lake bed; where dissected by small drainages the slope is gentle, but in several places is abrupt. Most of the site was formerly in cultivation and the topsoil, a grayish sand with liberal mixture of humus, is three to four feet thick and apparently fertile. The subsoil is a rather dense, reddish or orange sandy clay. The trees around the site are oak, persimmon, gum, and many smaller hawthorns and sassafras. The uplands have heavy growths of pine and the lake bed has the usual cypress, willows, and some hardwoods. The nearby lakes still have abundant fish—bass, crappie, “bream” and other small perches, as well as the “rough” varieties like gar, carp, catfish, shad, and “gasper-gou”—and turtles, eels, bullfrogs, snakes, and an occasional alligator are present. Bird species are abundant and in former years migratory waterfowl came in tremendous numbers. Edible wild fruits and nuts in the area are persimmons, haws, crab apples, plums, muscadines and other wild grapes, hickory nuts, walnuts, pecans, chinquapins (dwarf chestnuts), yoncapins (seed of *Nelumbo lutea*, a water lily), and many others. Deer were present until the early part of the 20th century and are now returning; squirrels, rabbits, raccoons, and opossums are the more prevalent of the edible animals. Mussels and snails are available in moderate numbers. In aboriginal and early historic times this vicinity afforded, undoubtedly, an abundance of natural resources, with good soil and adequate rainfall for domestic crops.



Fig. 1. Map of northwestern Louisiana and adjoining portion of eastern Texas. Listed sites have Alto Focus or related components. Note route of the early historic road, El Camino Real, which probably followed prehistoric trails through this area.

HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

During the 18th and 19th centuries this land was spoken of as “the coast,” inferring a large body of water into which the tongue of land projected. Like so many other lakes formed where streams run into the river valley out of the hills, it is probable that old natural river levees formed a bar or dam which produced the lake; some, however, are of the opinion that the famous log jam in Red River was instrumental in production of these lakes. At any rate, much of the traffic on the river above Alexandria coursed along these lateral streams and lakes. When we first visited this site, old residents spoke of a deep lake with steamboat landings at the site and on present Smithport Lake.

The desirability of this land for habitation is attested by the several prehistoric sites in the neighborhood, the size of the Smithport Landing Site, and the early documents which indicate a white settlement within a few years after establishment of Natchitoches Post. About equidistant (25-30 miles) from Natchitoches and the Spanish counter post at Los Adaes ([Fig. 1](#)), families and influences were derived from both the French and Spanish. Records at Natchitoches record the birth of Joseph Marcel Antonio De Soto, son of Manuel De Soto and Marie De St. Denis, member of the family of Louis Juchereau De St. Denis who founded Natchitoches, in 1758 (D'Antonio, 1961a). A later daughter married Paul Lafitte of Bayou Pierre, as the Smithport Lake Settlement was called.

The Spanish influence became stronger in the latter 1700's, after Louisiana was ceded to Spain. Even after the Louisiana Purchase, this land was on the margin of the "neutral ground" and for a time was under Spanish jurisdiction. This, as well as a comment about a Yatasi Indian village which may be of significance to the site, is indicated by D'Antoni's (1961a) account of the journey in 1808 of Don Marcelo De Soto, who had become Spanish judge of Bayou Pierre Community, to San Antonio to petition the governor for a resident pastor. The petition reads in part:

Don Marcelo de Soto, acting justice of Bayupier, Jurisdiction of Nacogdoches, together with Jose Lafitte, Silvestre Poissot, Pedro Robleau and Miguel Rambin, all of aforesaid community, who have come to this capital together, has the honor of appealing with all respect to your lordship's equity, conjointly with and in the name of all the other residents of the specified Bayupier. [These] consist of thirty Spanish families gathered together and long established in the aforesaid place, with no large number of educated persons at their service; besides, there is next to them the village of the Yatasi Indians. They are all in need of the church and of an ecclesiastic to minister the Holy Sacraments....

Although a resident pastor was not sent, priests from Nacogdoches visited the settlement for some years, then visitation was taken over by the French priests at Natchitoches. A chapel was constructed in 1843 "in the center of De Soto Parish at Bayou Pierre." In 1855 the first new parish

of the Natchitoches Diocese was established here and a resident priest assigned (D'Antoni, 1961b).

In 1888 a Carmelite Mission was established, with a monastery and subsequently separate schools for boys and girls (D'Antoni, 1962). The Carmelites built a rock chapel which is now preserved as an historic monument to their labors; the small settlement three miles east of the site is now called Carmel.

SITE EXPLORATION AND EXCAVATION

The Smithport Landing Site is located in Township 13 N, Range 12 W, sections 23 and 26, on land owned at present by Edward Lafitte of Carmel, but at the time of our excavation by Guy Sample of Shreveport. When first visited in 1934, much of the site was in cultivation; now it is in pasturage or woodlands. Evidences of occupation were found on portions of four hills, heaviest on hills 2 and 3 ([Fig. 2](#)). Larger than most sites in this area, we estimated that a total of 40 to 50 acres was occupied. We first explored Hill 1, a low hill which sloped gently to the bottom lands and had been in cultivation for a long time. The topsoil was thin and sheet erosion exposed a number of pottery sherds, projectile points, and other stone objects. It is possible that this was a separate site, since it is set apart by a wide stream bed from the other occupied hills, but the artifact types were not different. The area of occupation covered about five acres.

Hill 2 is higher, about 20 feet above the old lake bed, and slopes rather sharply southward to the lowlands. The top is gently rounded and had been put into cultivation only a few years before our first visit. The topsoil was very dark and many large pottery sherds were found; in fact, this hill showed the heaviest occupation of the site, over an area of 20 to 30 acres. The burials ([Fig. 3](#)) which are described later occurred on the crest of this hill, immediately overlooking the old lake.

Hills 3 and 4 run north-south and slope down to a small stream which separates them. The occupation areas, chiefly along the slopes to the stream, are estimated at five to ten acres on each hill, although we were uncertain about Hill 4 because it was partly wooded. There were two tenant houses in a nearby deserted field. On the back part of Hill 2 and east of the main

tenant house, very black soil, found over a radius of 12-15 feet, contained large sherds, numerous animal bones or bone fragments, and ashes ([Fig. 2](#)). Two test pits showed that the black refuse soil was two to three feet in depth and ashes indicated extensive cooking. Our notes show no evidence of a house floor or post molds, although we did not trench the area.

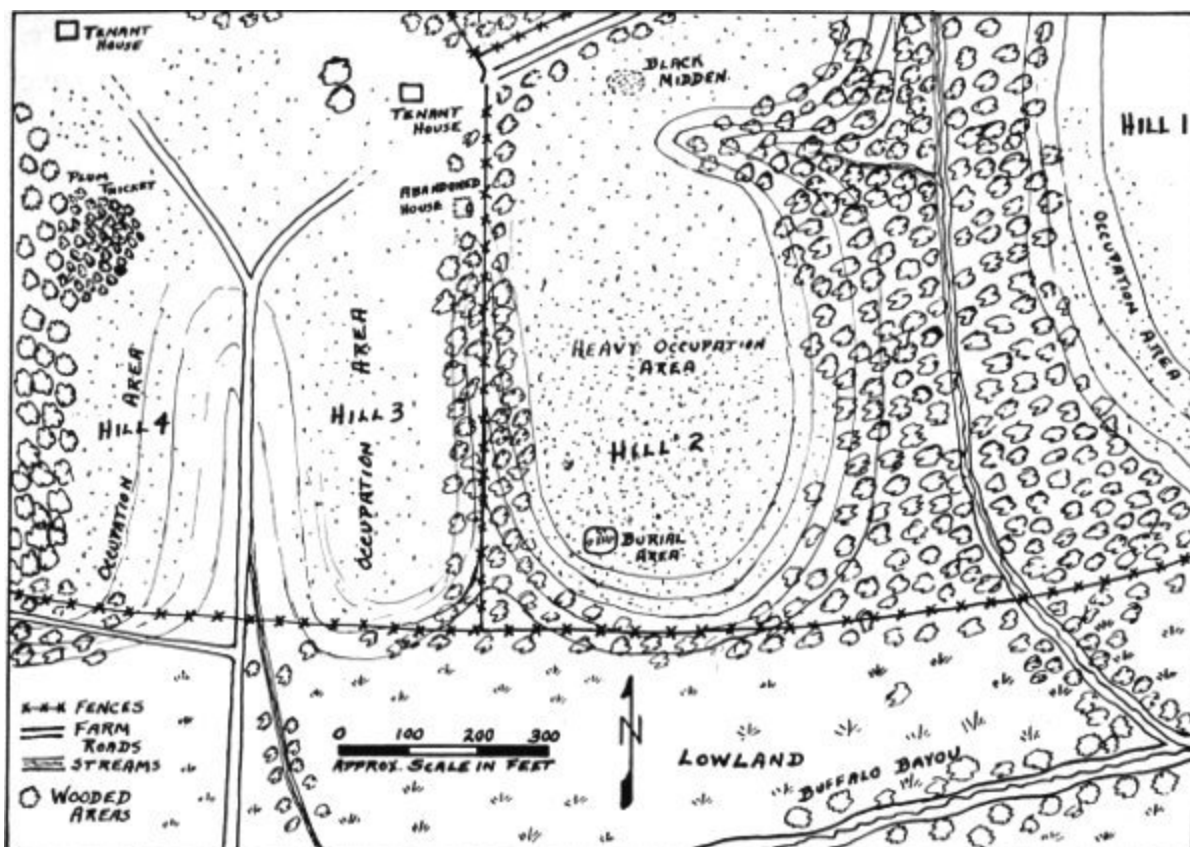


Fig. 2. Sketch of Smithport landing Site, not to scale. Note occupational areas on four hills, burial area and heavy midden on Hill 2.

BURIAL EXCAVATIONS

In May, 1935, Monroe Dodd, Jr., found a small intact vessel ([Fig. 4](#), O) in hog rootings on the crest of Hill 2, which had been left uncultivated and put into pasturage that year. Excavations exposed within a radius of two to three feet a cluster of nine pottery vessels ([Fig. 3](#), Nos. V-94-102), three of which were intact and four largely so. Included are vessels shown in [Figure 4](#), B, C, F, K, N, O, and R. Vessels which are not illustrated are two broken

bottles (probably hit by the plow), one *Hickory Fine Engraved* and an untyped engraved ware with interlocking spirals. All of the vessels were within two feet of the surface, as were burials 1 and 2 ([Fig. 3](#)), male and female adults lying fully extended and supine, with heads turned to left and right, respectively. The pottery deposit could have related to either or both of these. Two *Alba* points were found to the side of Burial 1.

On weekend trips between May and November, 1935, with 149 permission of the owner, we worked out the remainder of the burials; see [Figure 3](#). As a result either of our inexperience or of the way the burials had been placed, we were not sure of pit outlines and of which skeletons were associated. All occurred at a depth of two to three feet from the surface, although disturbed soil continued to a depth of three to three and a half feet and in a few places to four feet. It was my impression, as recorded in notes, that burials 1 and 2 were together and that burials 5, 3-4, 6-8 and 11-13, and 9-10 represented interment groups.

Burials 3 and 4 were side by side and undoubtedly placed together. Both were supine and fully extended, except that the left arm of Burial 3 was abducted and flexed at right angles. Heads were directed almost south, that of 3 with face upward; the skull of Burial 4 was turned to the right. Both were adults, Burial 3 a female, 4 a male. A large, intact bottle ([Fig. 4](#), A) was two feet above the heads and a small bowl ([Fig. 4](#), I) was in fragments to the left of the skull of Burial 3.

Between this group and Burial 2 we found a skull and several long bones in an irregular bundle ([Fig. 3](#), Burial 5). There were no associated artifacts.

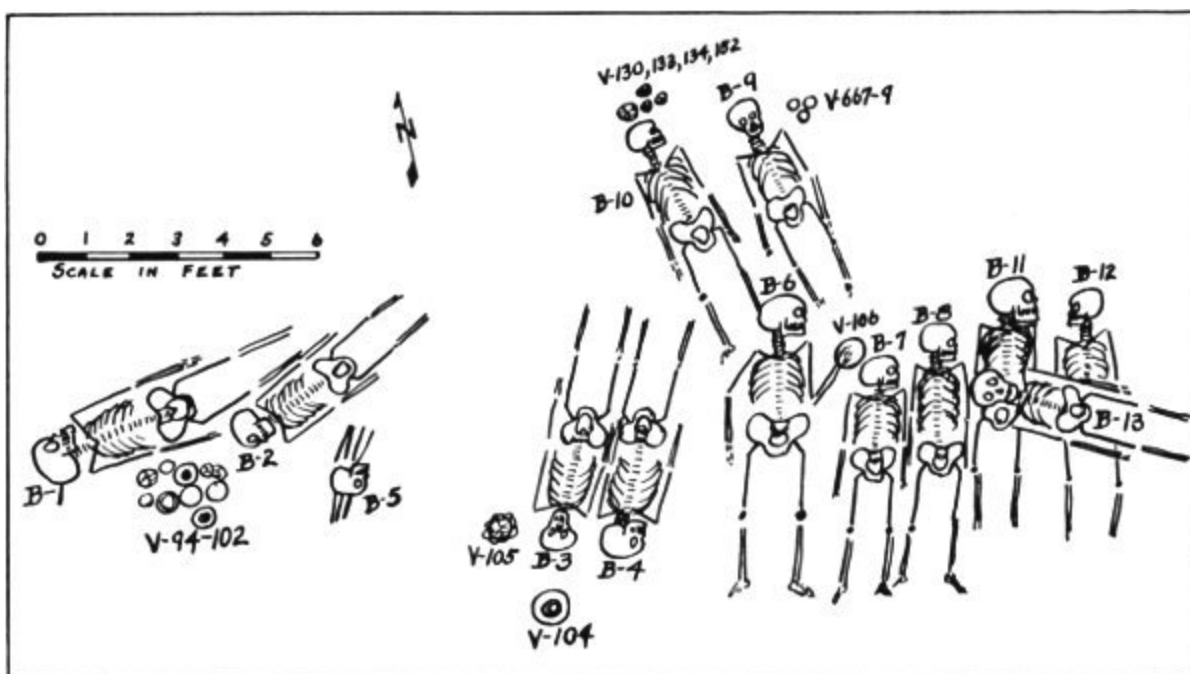


Fig. 3. Burials on Hill 2 of Smithport Landing Site. Vessel numbers are catalog numbers. Left arm of B-3 shown incorrectly; it should be abducted and flexed.

Burials 6 to 8 were about a foot apart, on the same level, and were thought to be a single interment. Heads were directed north, all turned towards the left side, and the bodies were supine and extended, except that the left arm of Burial 6 was flexed, with the hand lying over a pottery vessel above the head of Burial 7 (Fig. 3). This vessel, an intact cylindrical jar of the type *Kiam Incised* (Fig. 4, D) was the only offering. Burial 6 was that of a female, age estimated 40-50 years, rather gracile in build. Burial 7 was a child of 13-15 years and Burial 8 was either an adolescent or young adult female.

Burials 11 to 13, found on a subsequent visit, may have been a part of the burial 6-8 interment, as they were at the same depth (three feet), were immediately adjacent, and lay in the same orientation. Burial 11 was a male, supine and extended, with head directed north and turned to the left. Age was estimated at 18-20 years. Burial 12 was a female adult, also supine, fully extended and head directed north but rotated to the right to face Burial 11. Burial 13 was a female adult, lying across and directly on the previous two, with head directed just north of west and face turned upward. No artifacts were with these three.

Burials 9 and 10 were probably associated but separate from the others. They were north of the previous row of burials, with head orientation toward the north, supine, extended, and the feet just above the skulls of burials 6 and 7. Burial 9 had the face upright, and was a child of undetermined age. Burial 10 was of a female adult with head turned to the left, toward 9. Above the skull of Burial 10 there were pottery fragments which were later assembled to form vessels 130, 133, and 134 ([Fig. 4](#), H, E, and G, respectively) and a toy bottle ([Fig. 4](#), P). To the left of the skull of Burial 9 there were three small vessels, two plain bowls, and a fingernail-pinched cup ([Fig. 4](#), L, M, Q).

In November, 1935, a final burial (not shown in [Fig. 3](#)) was found, six feet east of burials 12 and 13. This was of a male adult, turned on the right side with legs partially flexed and the head directed to southeast. No artifacts were associated.

Measurements were made on three intact skulls. That of Burial 6, adult female, had a circumference of 47 cm., glabella to occipital protuberance 27 cm., and zygoma to zygoma 30 cm. The skull of Burial 10, adult female, had circumference of 46.8 cm., glabella to occipital protuberance 28.5 cm., and zygoma to zygoma 31 cm. That of Burial 14, adult male, had circumference of 49.5 cm., glabella to occipital protuberance 29.2 cm., and zygoma to zygoma 30.5 cm.

DESCRIPTION OF ARTIFACTS

CERAMICS

There are available for study of pottery from this site 19 whole vessels from the burials, of which 10 are decorated and nine plain; 1533 sherds from surface collections and the several test pits, of which 875 are decorated and 658 plain. Among the sherds there is a group of 37 which have paste and decoration characteristics of late wares, historic or protohistoric, which will be described in a separate section. Consequently there are 19 whole vessels and 1496 sherds which relate to the earlier occupation. Most of these are assignable to existing types which have been described elsewhere and type descriptions will not be repeated, although local or regional variations will be indicated. Reference should be made to

the Davis Site report (Newell and Krieger, 1949) and T. A. S. handbooks (Suhm, *et al.*, 1954; Suhm and Jelks, 1962) for descriptions of Alto types; to the Bossier Focus report (Webb, 1948) and the handbooks for the Bossier types; and to the Crooks (Ford and Willey, 1940), Greenhouse (Ford, 1951), and Medora (Quimby, 1951) Site reports for Coles Creek and Plaquemine types. One new type of the Alto period, *Carmel Engraved*, will be described herein.

Certain characteristics of paste, temper, surface and core colors, and sherd thickness extend throughout the earlier wares from this site. The paste is generally uniform and compact, rarely lumpy or porous. The range of hardness is 2 to 3 (Moh's Scale), the sherds are broken with difficulty and seldom can be scored with a fingernail; the majority of the sherds give a metallic ring when dropped on a hard surface (except for the dark chocolate to black wares). Tempering is clay-grit in most instances, sometimes with finely ground sherds, and a few with enough grit to feel slightly sandy (none is fully sand tempered). Bone temper occurs in 31 of the 1496 sherds (2%) and shell is totally missing.

Surface colors are predominantly light, showing oxidizing firing conditions, and fire clouds are frequent ([Fig. 4](#), A-C), indicating incomplete control of firing. The majority of sherds have light interiors and cores, but some of the interiors are darker gray or smudged and some of the cores are dark brown to black, even though the surfaces are light. Surface colors are varying shades of gray, some buff or tan, a few orange or reddish-brown; in every type there will be varying percentages of dark brown (often chocolate or reddish-brown) to black, although these are never as numerous as in the Alto wares of the Davis Site, even in the engraved types. The sherds with chocolate brown to black exteriors usually have uniform darkness through the core and on interior surfaces; the paste is usually softer and the sherds seldom give a metallic ring when dropped. Their surfaces tend to be smoothed but rarely polished.

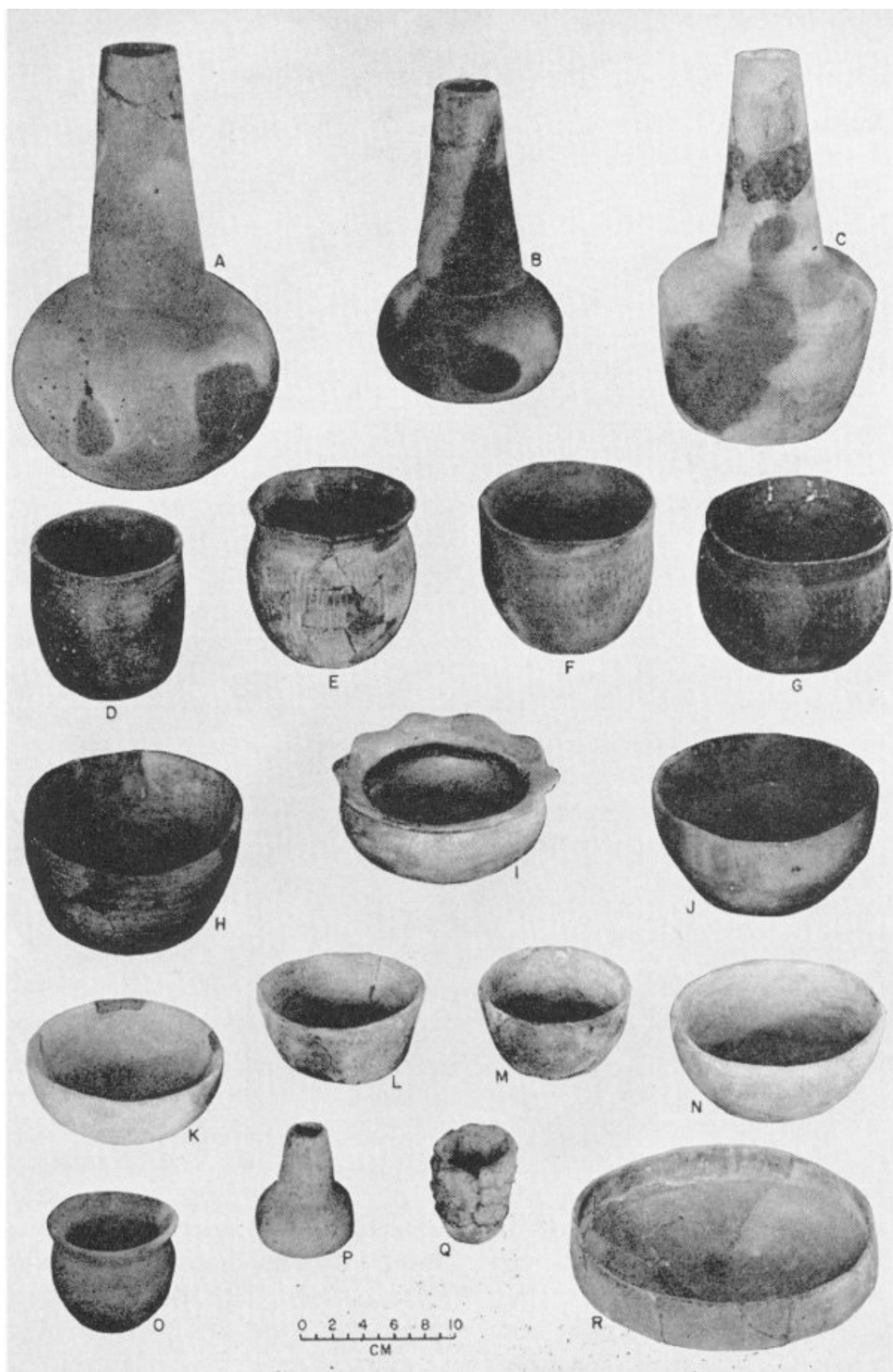


Fig. 4. Pottery From Burials. A, B, *Smithport Plain* bottles, V-104, 95. C, *Hickory Fine Engraved*, V-96. D-G, *Kiam Incised* jars, V-106, 133, 94, 134 (note plain body on D, vertical incising on E, fingernail punctating of F, G). H, *Davis Incised*, V-130. I, Untyped, V-105 (plain body, scalloped rim with free punctations on lower surface). J, *Smithport Plain* bowl from Allen Site. K-N, *Smithport Plain* bowls, V-99, 667, 668, 100. O-P, *Smithport Plain* miniatures, V-97, 152. Q, *Wilkinson Punctated* (pinched miniature), V-669. R, *Smithport Plain* carinated bowl, V-101.

Sherd thickness varies from 4 to 10 mm., averaging 6 to 7 mm. in most types. Variations will be noted. 153

In general, this early ware is thicker and lighter in color than the later Caddoan wares of the Belcher and late Bossier periods. It is about the same thickness as the Alto wares of the Davis Site and the Coles Creek-Early Plaquemine of central Louisiana, but differs from Davis Alto in having less of the reddish and chocolate to black polished pottery and more buff to light gray. It shares bone tempering with Texas (Davis) Alto. In other respects of hardness and coloration, it more nearly approaches Coles Creek ceramics, although seldom having the orange tints and never the greenish tints of Coles Creek. It tends to be thicker, harder, and lighter in color than Plaquemine pottery, although some of the shapes and designs are similar to Plaquemine types.

A. Engraved Wares

Holly Fine Engraved type is represented by 10 sherds ([Fig. 5](#), A, B), one from a bottle, five from shallow bowls, and four uncertain. Indicated height of bowl rims is 2.5 to 3 cm., vertical or mildly outsloping. Colors are tan, gray and brown, no black polished. Two of the sherds are bone tempered. Wall thickness is 6 to 9 mm. The engraved lines are usually diagonal on the bowls and seven have excised triangles.

Hickory Fine Engraved type includes two whole vessels, both bottles, and nine sherds from four bowls, one bottle, two small jar or cup forms, and two of uncertain form. The first bottle ([Fig. 4](#), C) is 26 cm. high, 14 cm. in body diameter, has an evenly tapered spout and shouldered body. Three lightly engraved lines encircle the shoulder. The second bottle, which also occurred with Burial 1, has the spout missing but body intact. The body is 12.6 cm.

high, 15.2 cm. in diameter, and has eight engraved lines encircling the upper body area. Both of these bottles are gray in color, with black fire clouds, and are clay tempered. Eight of the sherds of this type ([Fig. 5](#), E, G) are tan to gray with black areas, while the ninth ([Fig. 5](#), F) is black and polished, with cross-engraved decoration. No other *Hickory* sherd is polished. Temper is clay-grit or sherd, one with bone. The bowls appear to have vertical or outsloping rims, with walls 5 to 7 mm. thick, but one sherd is from an incurvate bowl, 4 mm. thick. Five of the sherds have horizontally engraved lines, 4 to 9 mm. apart; three have diagonal parallel lines and one has cross diagonals. The latter is a rim sherd and the rounded lip has transverse notching 7-9 mm. apart ([Fig. 5](#), F).

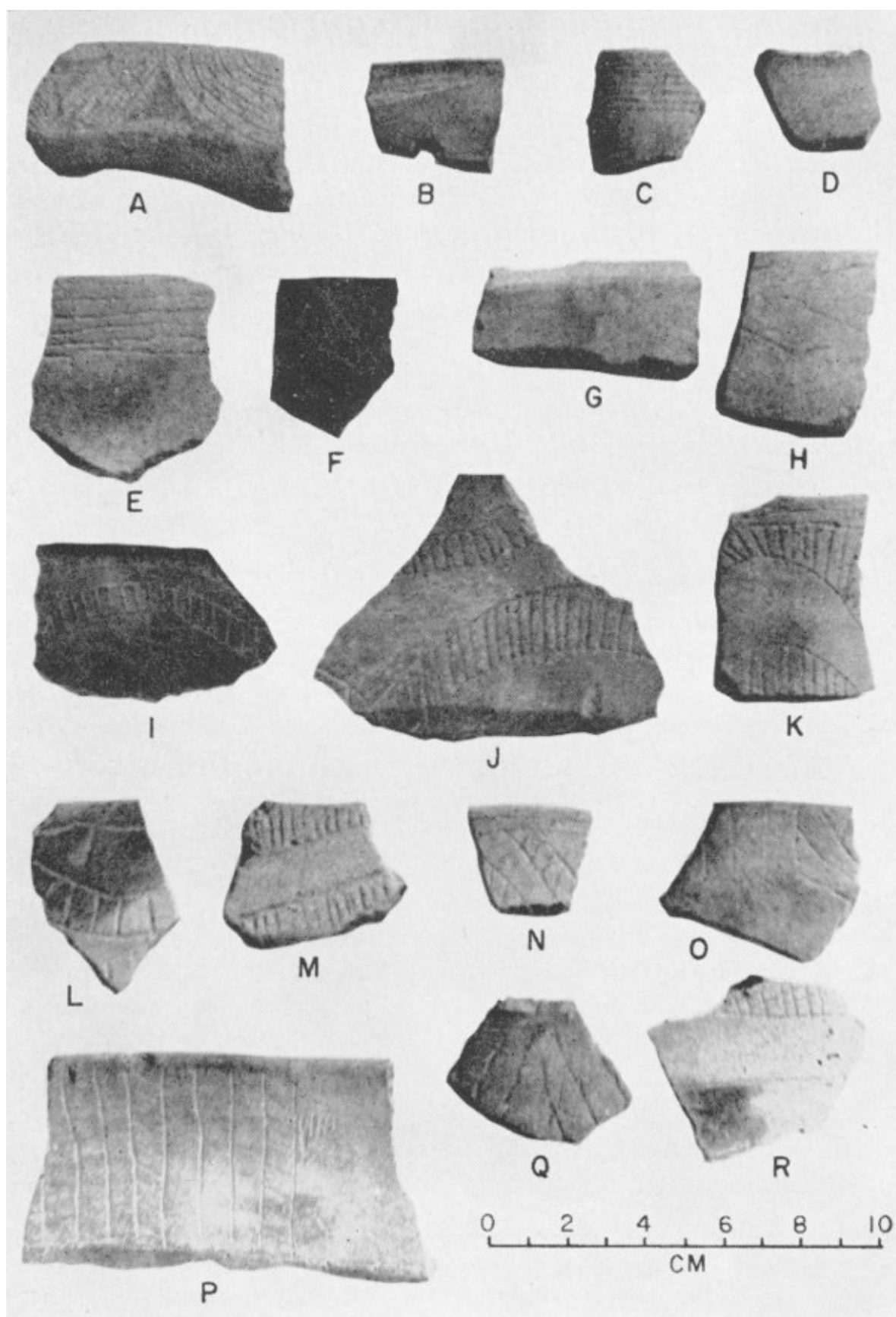


Fig. 5. Engraved Sherds. A, B, *Holly Fine Engraved*. C, D, *Holly or Hickory Fine Engraved*. E-G, *Hickory Fine Engraved*; H, Untyped zig-zag engraved. I-P, *Carmel Engraved*. Q, Untyped with spurred engraved lines. R, Probable *Maddox Engraved*.

155

Six sherds could be either *Holly* or *Hickory Fine Engraved* (Fig. 5, C, D). One is from the top of a bottle spout, another from a bottle shoulder, two are bowl sherds, and the other forms are doubtful. The bottle sherds have horizontally engraved lines, the other four are diagonal. One bowl sherd, light in surface color, is only 4 mm. thick. The surface colors of both *Holly* and *Hickory Fine Engraved* types at this site are more like the later (Phase 2 and 3) periods at the Davis Site; the earlier vessels at Davis were preponderantly dark in surface color.

Carmel Engraved Type
(Fig. 5, I-P)

This is presented as a new type, as it is a major engraved type at this site—with 17 sherds, of which 11 are rim sherds—and has been found with Alto pottery at five other sites in northwestern Louisiana. There were five *Carmel Engraved* sherds from the Colbert Site; four each from Greer, Mounds Plantation, and Marston sites; and three from Chamarre Lake Site. The description is based on the Smithport collection.

METHOD OF MANUFACTURE: Coiled.

PASTE

Temper: Clay-grit or ground sherd; bone in 2 of 17 sherds.

Texture: Compact, generally fine, occasionally coarse.

Color: Shades of gray from light to almost black, often on same sherd (fire clouds); buff, tan and reddish-brown. Nearly half of the Smithport sample has reddish-brown exteriors and interiors. Cores may be same color as exterior, sometimes darker.

Surface Finish: Smoothed exteriors and interiors, a few with fair polish, none highly polished.

FORM

Wall Thickness: 5 to 7 mm., uniform.

Lip: Rounded, usually unmodified; occasional thinning.

Base: Uncertain, probably mildly convex, circular.

Vessel Shape and Size: So far as presently known, open and carinated bowls only. Rims are 3 to 7 cm. in height, about equally divided between 3-5 and 5-7 cm. range, from an obtuse angle at the junction of base and rim. The bases appear to be shallow; the rims mildly excurvate, or direct and slanted outward. A few appear to be vertical. Curvatures suggest diameters of 20-30 cm.

DECORATION

Treatment: Engraving.

Designs: Effected with heavy engraving on exteriors of rims only. Curving, wide bands outlined by parallel single engraved lines, with transverse, widely spaced lines producing a ladder effect. Usually two of such bands form arcs or meanders, with undecorated bands of similar width between them ([Fig. 5](#), I-K). Occasionally one or more engraved lines flank the engraved bands or bisect the intervening plain band. Some sherds ([Fig. 5](#), M, N, P) have straight instead of curving bands, but otherwise seem to fit into the type.

CULTURAL AFFILIATIONS

This type has occurred only in sites which have Alto Focus pottery; it has not been found in Bossier Focus sites which lack established Alto types. In the Bossier Focus, the related engraved type seems to be *Maddox Engraved*, which in northwestern Louisiana has cross-hatched engraved bands, generally not curving and most often vertical, as the major element. In central Louisiana *Maddox Engraved* type has been extended to include curvilinear bands of cross-hatched engraving (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: Pl. 50). The decoration on Plate 50, *F* of this handbook is very much like *Carmel Engraved* and this vessel probably should be included in this type instead of *Maddox*.

DISTRIBUTION

In addition to the Smithport Site, *Carmel Engraved* has been found at one mound and four village sites in northwestern Louisiana.

There is one untyped engraved vessel and seven sherds. The vessel (V-102), from Burial 1 is a bottle (with missing spout) of polished black ware, decorated with engraved interlocking spiral design, four times repeated. One sherd ([Fig. 5](#), H) has a zig-zag engraved decoration with excisions at the angles, similar to the two sherds illustrated from the Davis Site (Newell and Krieger: 1949, Fig. 34, S, T). Three sherds have bands with cross hatching, probably *Maddox Engraved* motifs, but the sherds are too small to be sure about the design ([Fig. 5](#), R). A bottle sherd ([Fig. 5](#), Q) has diagonal spurred engraved lines. Two bowl sherds are from polished black wares, with designs which suggest the *Glassell Engraved* type (Webb, 1959: Fig. 118).

B. Incised Pottery Types

Davis Incised type is represented by one vessel ([Fig. 4](#), H) and 17 sherds. The vessel is a deep, reddish-brown bowl, which curves outward from a slightly convex disc base, then is vertical to the rounded, unmodified lip. It is 10 cm. in height, 15.2 cm. in greatest diameter. There are five parallel, smoothed-over incised lines around the upper body, placed about 1 cm. apart. They are shallow and about 2 mm. in width. The surfaces are smoothed and questionably polished. The 17 sherds ([Fig. 6](#), A-E) include 11 rim sherds, nine of which indicate vertical walls, two outward sloping (but no excurvate). Most of the vessels seem to be deep bowls, but two sherds indicate shallower carinated bowls with inward curving or sloping rims. All are clay or grit tempered, with walls 4.5 to 8 mm. thick. Three are black, others gray, buff, light brown or tan in surface color; surfaces are smoothed and one of the black sherds ([Fig. 6](#), C) is polished lightly. The lips are rounded and unmodified except that most are thinned by an extra outward curving of the interior wall. The incised lines are smoothed over, 5 to 13 mm. apart and are 3 to 10 in number. Half of the lines are less than 1 mm. in width, the others are between 1 and 2 mm. wide, generally shallow and well executed.

Nine sherds are classified as *Sanson Incised* (Ford and Willey, 1940) because of the wide, shallow, smoothed incising in straight lines ([Fig. 6](#), F, G). No rim sherds were found, hence patterning of the incising is indefinite.

Tempering is clay-grit, the surface coloring is gray to black or dark brown, and the thickness is 5 to 8 mm. The incised lines are 2.5 to 4.5 mm. in width and appear to have been made with tools which had bluntly rounded or flat ends.

Two sherds ([Fig. 6](#), H, I) are possibly *Mazique Incised* (Ford, 1951) but may be well executed *Dunkin Incised*. They are light gray and tan in color, and one is a rim sherd. The decoration consists of finely made parallel incisions, closely placed in diagonal fields or herring-bone effect on the upper body. Vessel shape is uncertain.

Coles Creek Incised type is represented by eight sherds, although it is almost certain that some which are typed as *Hardy* or *Kiam Incised* are in reality *Coles Creek*. In order to be certain of Coles Creek Period wares at this site, I have included in this type only those sherds whose paste characteristics are consistent and which have “overhanging” parallel lines around the rim ([Fig. 6](#), J) or characteristically placed triangular punctations below the incised lines ([Fig. 6](#), K). Surfaces are smoothed and are buff or gray in color. The incisions are bold, horizontal, and usually more closely spaced than in *Davis Incised*. The subjacent triangles on four sherds are pressed into the paste more deeply at the apex. It must be pointed out that it is not a simple task, in studying sherds from northern Louisiana, to distinguish the four related types which are characterized by parallel incisions around the rim—*Davis Incised*, *Coles Creek Incised*, *Hardy Incised*, and *Kiam Incised*—unless the technique and paste are characteristic or a large part of the vessel available. Much overlapping occurs.

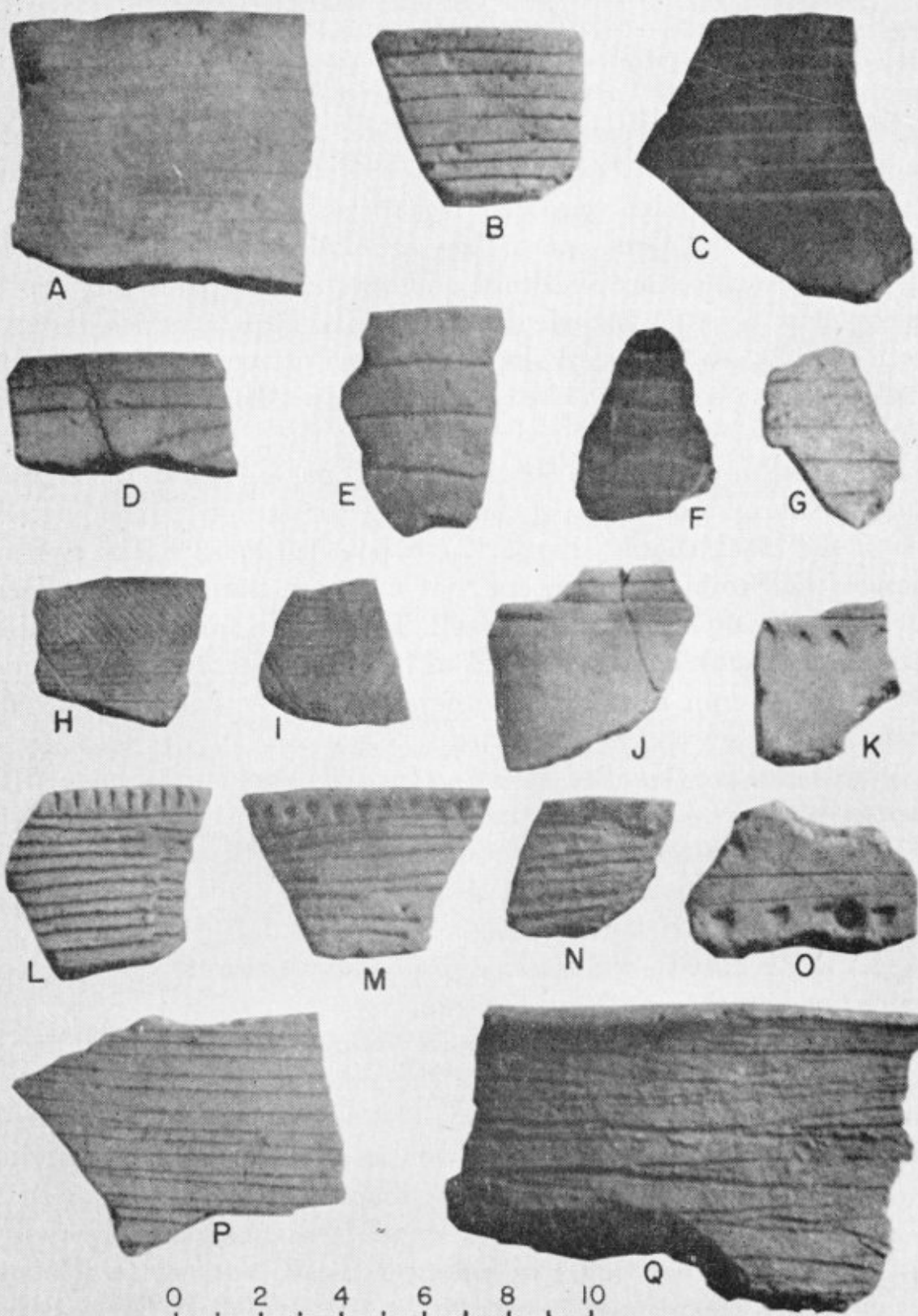


Fig. 6. Incised Sherds. A-E, *Davis Incised* (A resembles high rim of jars which are frequent in Haley pottery). F, G, *Sanson Incised*. H, I, *Mazique Incised*. J, K, *Coles Creek Incised*. L-Q, *Kiam* or *Hardy Incised* (note outer lip notching or punctations on L-N, also suspension hole and subjacent hemiconical punctation on O, almost certainly *Hardy Incised*).

One hundred and seventy four sherds from this site are included in type *Kiam Incised* or *Hardy Incised* (Fig. 6, L-Q). No attempt shall be made to distinguish between these types, but the problem will be pointed out and resolution left for future conferences. These sherds are characterized by parallel incised lines covering the rim or upper part of the vessel. Fortunately, there are four complete vessels from the burials (Fig. 4, D-G) which are typical *Kiam Incised* (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: 89, Pl. 45) and established the presence of this type. Vessel 106 (Fig. 4, D) is a heavy, thick-walled cylindrical jar with a slightly recurved and rounded lip. It is 11 cm. high, 10.6 cm. in diameter, clay tempered, and dark reddish-brown in color. Decoration consists of numerous scratchy incisions covering the upper 3 cm.; it is plain below this zone. Vessel 133 (Fig. 4, E) is a jar with narrow excurvate rim and semiglobular body. It is 12 cm. in height and in greatest width, and is clay tempered, with irregular light and dark gray surface color. The rim has three to four irregular, wavy incised lines which are not continuous; the body is covered with vertical, firm incisions spaced 4 to 7 mm. apart. Vessel 94 (Fig. 4, F) is a firm, intact, well made cylindrical jar, clay tempered, with dark gray-brown surface color except for a few light fire clouds. The upper 2.5 cm. has irregular horizontal incisions, 5 to 7 in number, and the remaining body exterior is covered with fingernail punctations, spaced rather regularly but not in exact rows. Vessel 134 (Fig. 4, G) is a jar with semiglobular body, narrowed toward the rim, which is vertical. The clay tempered paste is softer than the other three vessels and is fired black over the exterior, dark gray on the interior. It is 11 cm. high, 14 cm. wide. Decoration consists of five firmly incised lines around the rim exterior, spaced 3 to 5 mm. apart, and paired fingernail punctations or pinches covering the body. These vessels demonstrate the three most frequent body treatment techniques described for the *Kiam Incised* type.

The 174 sherds present more variation, and include 82 rim pieces. Temper is clay-grit or ground sherd except for five which are bone tempered. The

surface colors cover the range of tan, buff, yellow-orange, light to dark gray, reddish-brown and black; the light colors predominate. Interior and exterior surfaces are smoothed. Wall thickness is 5 to 10 mm., averaging 6.5 to 7 mm. The rim sherds show that about half have excurve rims, $\frac{1}{4}$ to $\frac{1}{5}$ of the vertical, and the others slant outward. Five have a row of punctations or notches on the rim exterior (Fig. 6, L-N), and one has transverse incisions on a flat lip. The lips are more often rounded, but about $\frac{1}{4}$ are flat; thinning may occur but not thickening.

The incising varies from thin scratchy lines made with a pointed tool, to rough and irregular (Fig. 6, Q), to firm, well made and regular (Fig. 6, L, M, P). The number of lines varies from two to 20 and the spacing from two to 10 mm. apart, often varying on the same sherd. Generally they are placed at 3 to 5 mm. intervals. Although most were produced with a pointed tool, a few were made with a blunt or square-tipped tool. Five have hemiconical or oval punctations below the last line (Fig. 6, O).

These characteristics as a unit do not fit either *Kiam* or *Hardy Incised* types. The predominant shape, with everted or excurve rim is more like *Kiam*, as are bone tempering, and either punctated bodies (two vessels, two sherds) or vertical incising on bodies (one vessel, two sherds). The paste and surface coloration are more like *Hardy Incised* (except for the five with bone temper), as are the subjacent punctations (Fig. 6, O), occasional stabs or punctations at the ends of lines (in central Louisiana, this occurs more often in *Yokena* and *French Fork Incised* than in *Hardy*), plain bodies (one vessel, five sherds), cutting away of the body wall just below the incisions (Fig. 4, D), and flattened lips. Not described for either *Kiam* or *Hardy* types are notched or incised lips, vertical rows of plowed-up paste where the incisions meet (Fig. 6, L) or narrow undecorated gaps at this junction, which occur on a number of the Smithport sherds. The conclusion seems obvious that *Kiam Incised*, *Hardy Incised* and the similar wares from this area are local or regional variations of a single widespread type.

The *Dunkin Incised* type presents the same problem. Although the sherds assigned to this type have more similarities to type *Dunkin Incised* than to any other, there are some similarities to *Mazique* and *Manchac Incised* types of central Louisiana, and some items which differ from all of these

types. Again, regional or temporal variations of a single type are indicated and should be subjected to study.

There are 117 sherds of *Dunkin Incised* which show incising in varying directions ([Fig. 7](#), A-L), usually including diagonal lines, and 65 sherds ([Fig. 7](#), O-R) which show only diagonal lines but are also assigned to *Dunkin*. Thirty of the former group and 25 of the latter are rim sherds. Paste characteristics, color, and wall thickness are the same as those described for *Kiam Incised*. The majority of the rim sherds indicate everted or excurve shapes, possibly a fourth are direct and vertical, none incurvate. Indicated vessel shapes are semiglobular jars with flaring rims, similar jars with narrowing at the neck and vertical or slightly everted rims, cylindrical vessels, and simple deep bowls. Lips are usually narrowed by outward curving of the interior wall, but may be rounded or occasionally flattened. There are no nodes or handles, and only one rim shows notching.

161

Incisions are generally bolder than in the *Kiam Incised* type, spaced 3 to 8 mm. apart, and seldom smoothed over. On the 117 sherds with lines in varying directions, 52 were made with a round-tipped tool, 47 with a pointed tool, 16 with square-tipped, and two with forked tool ([Fig. 7](#), D). In the instance of the rim sherds with diagonal incising, 17 of the 25 slant downward from right to left ([Fig. 7](#), P-R), eight from left to right ([Fig. 7](#), O). The lines may produce diamonds ([Fig. 7](#), C), triangles ([Fig. 7](#), A, D, J), chevrons ([Fig. 7](#), B) or, rarely, squares ([Fig. 7](#), I). Hemiconical or oval punctations are placed in a single row below the incising in two instances ([Fig. 7](#), L), above in one ([Fig. 7](#), E). The trait of making firm punctations at the ends of the lines ([Fig. 7](#), F, H-J) is more frequent than in type *Kiam Incised*, and gaps are left at times ([Fig. 7](#), F). One sherd ([Fig. 7](#), P) has a wide, smoothed band interrupting the previously placed incisions below the lip. The numerous body or rim-body sherds which show fields of varying incising more nearly resemble *Dunkin Incised* from the Davis Site in having full body decoration than the central Louisiana *Manchac* and *Mazique* types, where the decoration is usually confined to a narrow rim band.

Cross incising ([Fig. 7](#), M, N), which is called *Harrison Bayou Incised* (from the Harrison Bayou Site on Caddo Lake) in central Louisiana, but is included in *Dunkin Incised* in eastern Texas (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: Pl. 19),

is present on nine sherds from Smithport. They are clay tempered, light to dark gray in color, with smoothed surfaces. The incisions vary from narrow and closely placed to firm, wide lines.

Curvilinear incising is present on two sherds. These resemble curvilinear incising from the Sanson Site in central Louisiana which has been tentatively termed *Neild Incised*.

C. Punctated and Punctated-Incised Types

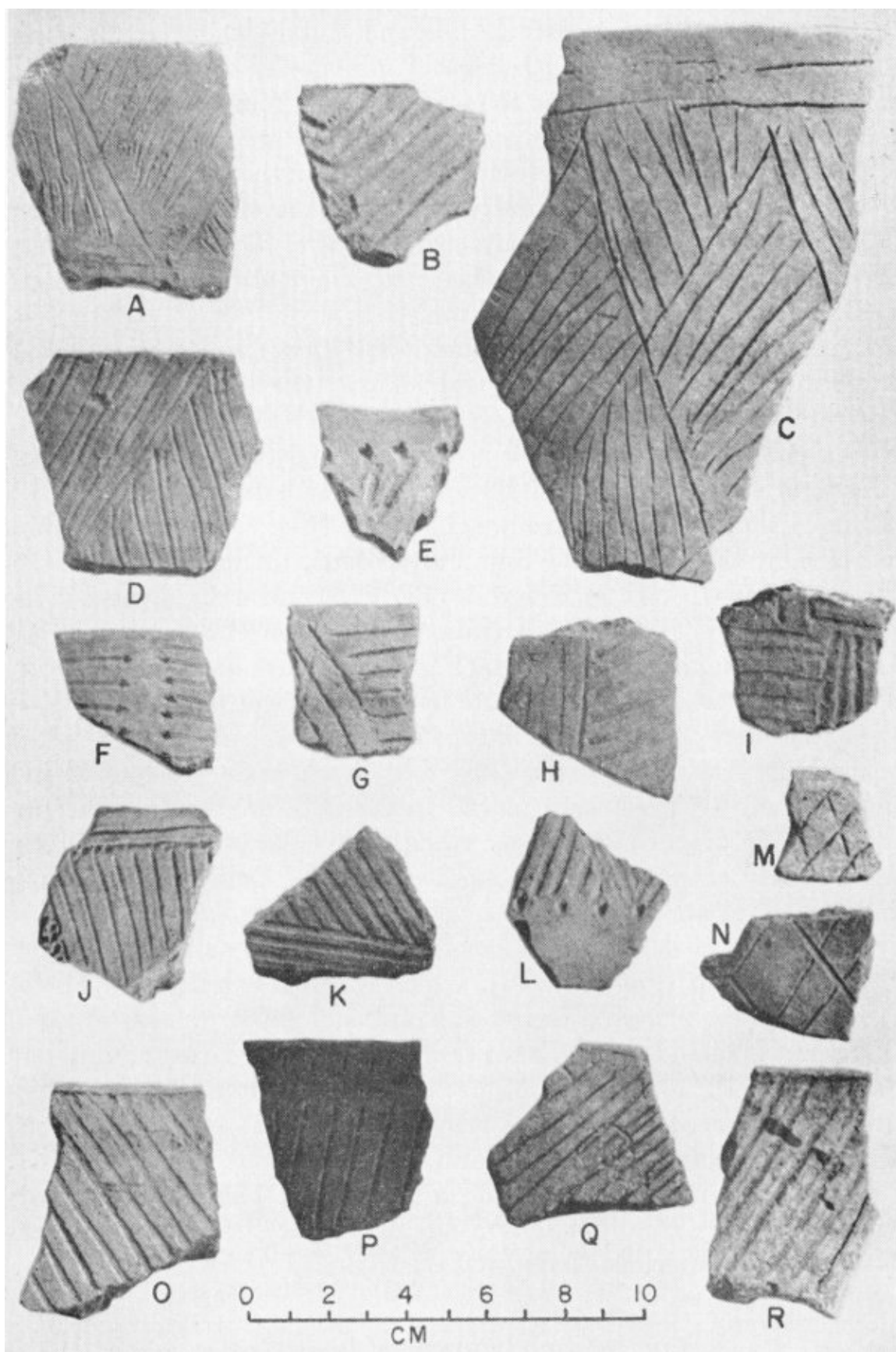


Fig. 7. Incised Sherds. A-L, *Dunkin Incised* (note C, a large sherd with typical design; punctations with lines on E, F, L: rectangular design on I). M, N, *Harrison Bayou Incised*. O-R, Diagonally incised rim sherds, probably *Dunkin Incised*.

Pennington Punctated-Incised type is represented by 36 sherds ([Fig. 8](#), A-F). Most of these derive from open carinated bowls with excurvate rims which are 4 to 7 cm. in height, but a few seem to be rims of recurved jars. Eight are chocolate brown in color, others tan, gray and brown-black. The paste is firm, hard in all but two sherds, with smoothed but not polished surfaces. Two sherds are tempered with bone, the others with clay-grit or sherd. Wall thickness is in the range of 5 to 9 mm., most specimens being 6 to 7 mm. The punctations are consistently placed in fields which are outlined by single deeply incised lines; the fields are in diagonal bands, diamonds or triangles. The punctations and incised lines are bold and the 36 sherds include punctations made with a pointed or round-tipped tool in 23 instances, comma-shaped in four, square ([Fig. 8](#), E) in five, and triangular in four. 163

Eleven sherds show the hybrid *Pennington-Crockett* design described in the Davis report (Newell and Krieger, 1949: 101). Shapes and paste characteristics are described above; two sherds are soft, chocolate brown in color. One has an incurving rim and a suspension hole ([Fig. 8](#), I). The bordering incised line is curved ([Fig. 8](#), G-I); otherwise these sherds do not differ from the *Pennington* type. Seven have rounded punctations, two are comma-shaped, one rectangular, and one square.

Another group of 19 sherds shows *zone punctations* which differ in certain respects from the typical *Pennington* described above and possibly are nearer to *Rhinehart Punctated* (Ford, 1951: 83-85). These 19 sherds ([Fig. 8](#), J-O) have the same range of paste and coloration; five are of the softer chocolate brown ware. Rim and body sherds are represented and in only one instance ([Fig. 8](#), O) is it certain that the rim is from an open carinated bowl as are the *Pennington* sherds. One heavy sherd ([Fig. 8](#), J) which is 12 mm. thick, suggests a globular vessel which narrows at the neck and recurves to upright at the rim. Another sherd includes the lower rim area which is decorated with zoned punctations and incisions, and the adjoining upper body which is plain. Characteristic of this group is the alternation of

punctated and incised fields, or the outlining of punctated zones by multiple incised lines. The punctations are triangular in three instances, square in one, comma-shaped in six, round or oval in five, small pits in three, and crescentic in one.

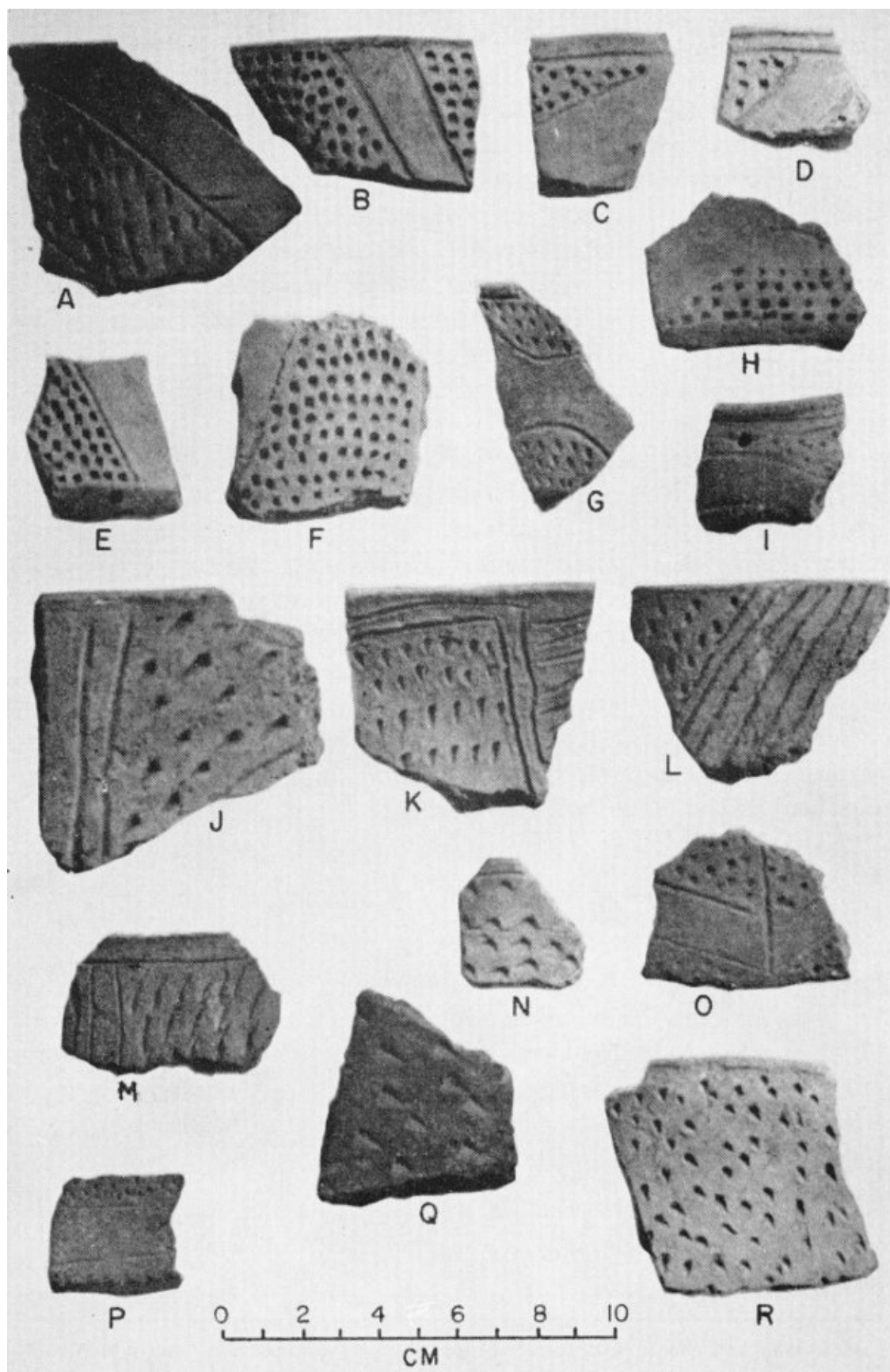


Fig. 8. Punctated Sherds. A-F, *Pennington Punctated-Incised*. G-I, *Pennington-Crockett* hybrid (I has incurving rim, hole for suspension). J-O, *Pennington* or *Rhinehart Punctated* (N has triangular punctations between horizontal lines in Coles Creek tradition). P, Similar to *Dupree Incised* but shape suggests *Bossier* sherd. Q, R, Random punctations.

Free punctations made with tools, without zoning or incising, are present on one vessel (Fig. 4, I) and 19 sherds (Fig. 8, Q, R). Paste and color are as described above; one is bone tempered, six are soft, chocolate brown in color. Rim and body sherds are represented but shapes of vessels are uncertain. The punctations are triangular in seven instances, comma-shaped in three, square in five, round in three, and crescentic in two. The vessel (V-105) is a semiglobular bowl with plain body and scalloped, everted rim. The lower surface of the rim is covered with free punctations. The relative increase in frequency of triangular punctations in this group is significant, in view of the fact that the *Rhinehart Punctated* type in central Louisiana features triangular punctations (Ford, 1951: 83), whereas they are infrequent in *Pennington Punctated-Incised* at the Davis Site (Newell and Krieger, 1949: 106-8). The absence of ring punctations at Smithport is remarkable, in view of their frequency at both the Davis Site and in central Louisiana.

A group of six sherds has minute *free* or *zoned punctations*. The sherds are thinner walled than average, 4 to 6 mm., and five of the six have black surfaces and soft pastes. The sixth is buff colored, thin and has a strongly excurvate, narrow rim. Another (Fig. 8, P) is from an open carinated bowl and has notches along the carina. All of this group may relate to the Bossier ceramics at this site, instead of Alto. They bear some similarity to *Dupree Incised* of Plaquemine ceramics in central Louisiana (Quimby, 1951: 122-3).

Weches Fingernail Impressed (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: 153, Pl. 77; Newell and Krieger, 1949: 118-20, Fig. 46) is represented by 19 sherds of characteristic design (Fig. 9, A-E). Nine of these include the lip area, but all appear to be rim sherds. In three instances some of the subjacent body wall is attached; on two of these the body is plain, on the third (Fig. 9, E) the body has diagonal incised lines suggesting *Dunkin*-like decoration. These three have globular bodies and outward curving or slanting rims, 4 to 4.5

cm. high. Other vessels seem to be cylindrical with vertical rims, and open carinated bowls are possible. Five of the 19 sherds are chocolate brown in color with clay tempered paste; the others range from tan and buff to dark gray and reddish-brown. Wall thickness is in the range of 4 to 9 mm., the majority 5-7 mm. Typically, the decoration ([Fig. 9](#), A, B, D, E) is with widely spaced horizontal incised lines with arcs or quarter circles between; the arcs could have been cut with the fingernail and occasionally are fingernail impressed, but in most the arc is too large, 1.8 to 4 cm. (my thumbnail is 1.6 cm. wide). Four of the sherds have the arcs without intervening lines ([Fig. 9](#), C).

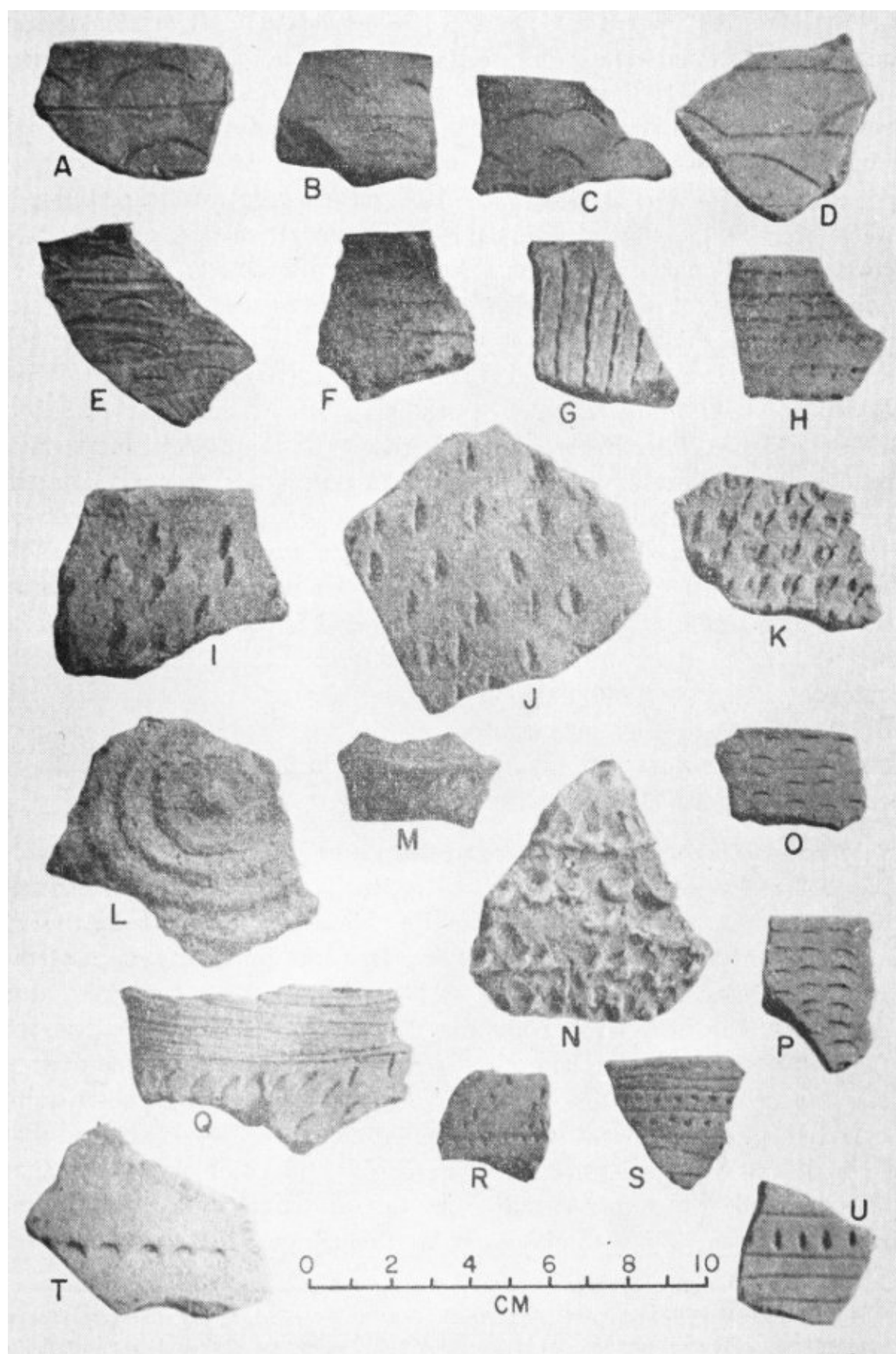


Fig. 9. Nail Impressed and Punctated Sherds. A-E, *Weches Fingernail Impressed*. F, *Weches Variant* with tool punctations. G, H, *Sinner Linear Punctated*. I-K, M-P, *Wilkinson Punctated*. L, Ridge pinched, similar to *Killough Pinched*. Q, *Wilkinson Punctated* body, *Kiam Incised* rim. R, S, U, Narrow bands with round or oval punctations. T, Single row of semilunar punctations.

Four sherds are identical with this group except that the spaces 167 between the horizontal lines have triangular instead of semilunar punctations ([Fig. 9](#), F). Seven other sherds have round or oval punctations in single rows between incised lines ([Fig. 9](#), R, S, U). I have not included these with type *Pennington Punctated-Incised*, as Krieger did with some reservation (Newell and Krieger, 1949: 106). Neither have I assigned them to *Coles Creek Incised*, *Hardy Incised* or *Rhinehart Punctated*, as Ford did, also probably with some reservation (Ford, 1951: Pls. 16, L; 17, 20, H), but have preferred to describe them separately as interesting examples of regional variations and typing difficulties in eastern Texas, and northern and central Louisiana.

One sherd ([Fig. 9](#), T) has a single row of semilunar punctations and otherwise plain surface. It is thick, clay-grit tempered, and buff colored.

Wilkinson Fingernail Punctated type is represented by one vessel and 153 sherds. This was described as a minor type in central Louisiana (Ford and Willey, 1940: 50; Ford, 1951: 88-89) to include clay tempered vessels with fingernail punctations scattered over the vessel surface, arranged in irregular rows, or pinched in vertical rows. In that area it is rarely combined with incising and usually covers the entire vessel. Ford (1951: 88) thought it occurred at the latter part of the Coles Creek period and reached maximum popularity in the succeeding Plaquemine Period or later, but it was missing in Plaquemine context at Bayou Goula (Quimby, 1957) and Medora (Quimby, 1951) sites. In the Davis Site report (Newell and Krieger, 1949) it was not established as a type, as Krieger considered fingernail punctations to be a body treatment present in several types (*Kiam*, *Weches*, *Dunkin*, and *Duren Neck Banded*); he reported 20,000 body sherds with fingernail roughening from a total of 96,000 sherds. The difference in attitude 168 toward this type on the part of these investigators is understandable when we consider the differences in frequency and use of the decoration method in the two areas, also that Ford and his co-workers used all sherds

in typing, whereas Krieger translated sherds to vessels and used rim decoration as the determinant.

In northwestern Louisiana I have found *Wilkinson Punctated* a useful type in *sherd collection* studies because of its great frequency in Alto wares, its rarity in Coles Creek, and the rapid shift from nail roughening to ridging and brushing as body treatments concurrent with the development of Bossier, Belcher, and other later Caddoan ceramics. *Wilkinson Punctated* is therefore a good indicator of early (Alto) Caddoan occupation at a given site. At Smithport Landing there were 153 sherds ([Fig. 9](#), I-K, M-P) and one burial vessel, a pinched toy jar ([Fig. 4](#), Q), of this type. The vessel is 6 cm. high, 5 cm. wide, made of thick clay-tempered paste, roughly finished and decorated with three horizontal rows of nail pinching. The sherds include only four rims ([Fig. 9](#), I, O, P), showing how rarely this decoration, in northern Louisiana, covers the vessel. Most of the other sherds are recognizably body sherds, and in eight instances (as in [Fig. 9](#), Q) the body-rim juncture is present. The latter sherds have *Kiam Incised* decoration on the rim and appear to have come from a modified globular body shape with directly or mildly everted rim. Nine of the 153 sherds are bone tempered, the remainder are clay-grit or ground sherd, rather granular and coarse. The walls are thick in many instances, the range 4 to 10 mm. with the majority 7 to 8 mm. Many of the sherds are large ([Fig. 9](#), I, J) indicating large, heavy jar forms. Surface colors range from tan and buff to dark grays and a few reddish-browns, with more tendency to darker colors than in other types. The majority have irregular fingernail gouges ([Fig. 9](#), I, J), but some are pinched ([Fig. 9](#), K, M, N) and others impressed more delicately and regularly ([Fig. 9](#), O-Q).

Eight sherds have distinctly pinched-up ridges ([Fig. 9](#), L) which are circular or curvilinear in six instances, vertical in two. The burial vessel ([Fig. 4](#), Q) may belong with this group, although it has been tentatively classed as *Wilkinson Punctated*. The group with pinched ridges bears considerable resemblance to the type *Killough Pinched* (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: 91, Pl. 46) of Frankston and Titus foci, but, in the absence of other types characteristic of these assemblages, will not be so assigned.

Sinner Linear Punctated is a type which so far has been confined to Bossier and Haley foci (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: 143; Webb, 1948: 114) and the four sherds of this type from the Smithport Landing, although similar in paste, thickness and color to the Alto sherds, are probably referable to the subsequent (presumably) Bossier period at this site. Two are rim sherds; one of these (Fig. 9, G) has parallel, vertical linear punctating; another (Fig. 9, H) and a body sherd have horizontal lines; the fourth is uncertain. All have linear nail punctating and the more typical linear tool punctating is absent.

D. Stamped Types

One sherd of *Chevalier Stamped* is small (3×2 cm.) but has definite rocker stamping. It is of firm paste, tan exterior surface color with a black fire cloud at one edge, and black interior. Paste is homogeneous clay-grit with several bone fragments (accidental?); both surfaces are smoothed but not polished. In general appearance it resembles many of the Alto sherds from this site.

E. Ridged Types

The eleven sherds of *Belcher Ridged* type (Fig. 10, G, H) are generally thinner and darker than the Alto wares. Six are dark chocolate to black on both surfaces and through the cores; the other five have light buff to dark gray surfaces, four of these with black cores. One is bone tempered, all others clay-grit. No rims are represented and the body sherds are 3 to 5 mm. in wall thickness. Typically, the elevated ridges are vertical.

F. Brushed and Brushed-Incised types

There are 38 sherds of the *Pease Brushed-Incised* type (Fig. 10, A-F). The paste is smooth, clay-grit tempered except for one bone tempered; interiors are smoothed, exteriors roughened all over with the decoration. The color range is about as for other types; eight sherds are chocolate brown to black and slightly soft. Thickness is 4-5 mm. in 13 of the 38 sherds, 5 to 9 mm. in the remainder. The vertical panels characteristic of this type are separated by notched applique ridges in 28 (Fig. 10, B, D-F), by rows of tool or nail

punctations in seven ([Fig. 10](#), A), and by applique nodes in three ([Fig. 10](#), C). The panels are roughened by diagonal incisions in 24 instances ([Fig. 10](#), A, C), by vertical incising in 10 ([Fig. 10](#), E, F), by horizontal incising in one, and by brushing in three ([Fig. 10](#), B, D).

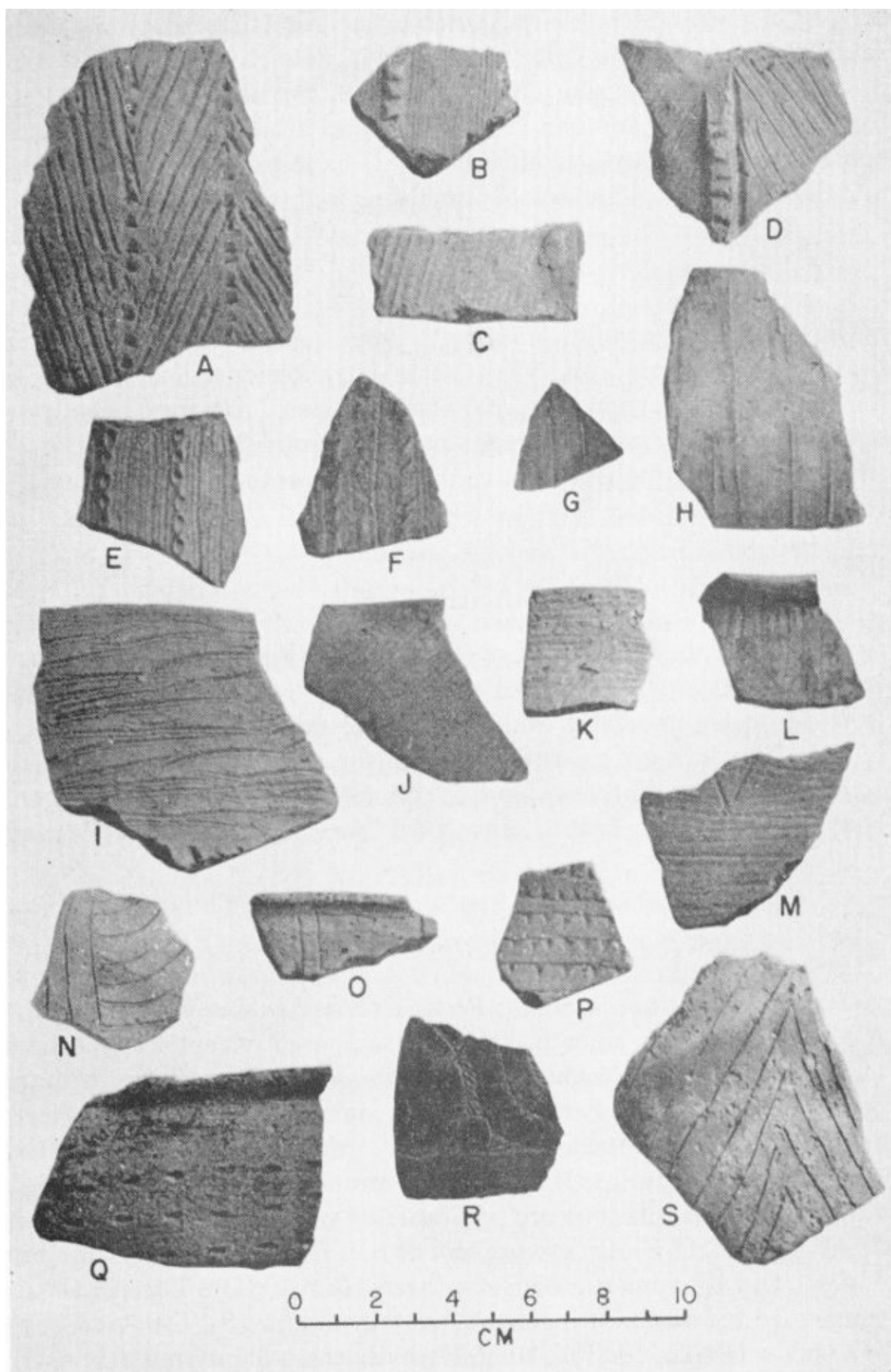


Fig. 10. Brushed, Ridged, and Late Wares. A-F, *Pease Brushed-Incised* (note panel separation by punctations on A, applique notched ridges on B, D-F, and applique nodes on C). G, H, *Belcher Ridged*. I-K, M *Bossier or Plaquemine Brushed*. L, *Karnack Brushed-Incised* (note rolled rim, rare). N-S, Late Glendora Focus sherds (N, S, shell tempered, incised; O, P, engraved, untyped; Q, linear punctated, untyped; R, *Hodges Engraved*).

Karnack Brushed-Incised type (Suhm and Jelks, 1962: 85) is applied 171 to barrel-shaped vessels with everted rims, decorated with vertical incising or brushing. Thirty-four sherds from Smithport fit this category, although it is possible that some of the vertically incised body sherds derive from *Kiam Incised* or *Weches Fingernail Impressed* vessels. There are only three rim sherds, one rolled ([Fig. 10](#), L), the other two everted. The paste, temper, color range, and wall thickness are no different from other types; seven of the sherds are dark chocolate brown in color. Only six sherds are less than 5 mm. in thickness and the average is 6.5 mm.; brushing is used on six of the sherds, vertical incising on the others, varying from firm to sloppy and scratchy.

The other brushed sherds from this site fall into the type which we now call *Bossier Brushed* (formerly *Maddox Brushed* included these and the vertically brushed included now in *Karnack Brushed-Incised*). It is very similar to or identical with *Plaquemine Brushed* type of the Plaquemine and late Coles Creek periods in central Louisiana. Chief indicated differences are rolled or narrow everted rims in some of the *Bossier* type, whereas they are direct or slightly everted in *Plaquemine*; more frequent cross brushing in *Plaquemine* than in *Bossier*; bone temper in a few of the *Bossier*, absent in *Plaquemine*; and an occasional row of punctations below the brushed zone in *Plaquemine*, not found in *Bossier*. These are minor differences, easily attributable to regional variations, and it would probably be desirable to define a single type, with recognition of minor local variations.

There are 31 *Bossier Brushed* sherds ([Fig. 10](#), I-K, M), of which seven are from rims. Temper is clay-grit or ground sherd; one is bone tempered. Surface colors include two black, four chocolate brown, the others lighter shades of tan, buff, and gray. Only five sherds are 5 mm. or less in thickness; others are 5.5-11 mm., averaging 7.3 mm. (It is thicker than most types.) The seven rim sherds have horizontal brushing on two, diagonal on

four, both on one. The body sherds show a similar distribution, with diagonal brushing predominating. Cross brushing or incising is present on seven ([Fig. 10](#), M).

G. Smithport Plain Type and Other Plain Sherds

There are nine plain vessels ([Fig. 4](#), A, B, K-P, R) from the burials and 644 plain sherds from this site which apparently relate to the earlier ceramics. The vessels, all identified as *Smithport Plain*, include three bottles, four simple bowls, one carinated bowl, and one recurved jar. *Smithport Plain* therefore runs the gamut of vessel forms common to decorated types; cylindrical jar forms are included in the sherds. The 644 plain sherds include 65 rim sherds (the only definite *Smithport* sherds), one-fourth as many as the total rim sherds in the decorated types and exceeded only by *Kiam Incised* with 82 rim sherds. The total number of plain sherds in our collection is altered by the element of selectivity in surface collecting; we were less likely to save plain sherds unless they were large or were rim sherds. The frequency of plain wares at this period contrasts with the situation in the later Bossier and Belcher ceramics, where undecorated vessels are infrequent. For example, at the Belcher Site (Webb, 1959) there were only nine plain vessels among the total of 195, and plain sherds constituted only 44 per cent of total sherds (most of these were from undecorated portions of decorated vessels).

The 65 *Smithport Plain* rims include 15 which are everted, 26 vertical, and 18 incurvate; additionally there are rims from two simple, shallow bowls, one rim with an exterior roll, one everted rim with interior bevel and exterior strap thickening, one bottle spout, and one shallow toy dish. The everted rims are unmodified in seven instances, and thinned in eight with rounded lips. Lip thinning of everted rims was effected by exaggerating the outward curve of the rim interior; that of incurvate bowls by exaggerating the exterior curve. The vertical rims are unmodified with rounded lips in 12 instances, thinned and rounded in eight, flat in four, and have beveled exteriors in two. The incurvate rims are thinned with rounded lips in nine, unmodified with rounded lips in five, flattened lips in two, externally beveled in one, and thickened with rounding in one.

The plain sherds include 20 recognizable as bases, nine of which are complete flat discs. These range from 6 to 13 cm. in diameter and are 6 to 12 mm. thick. One large basal sherd has a smooth central perforation, 13 mm. in diameter, and rounded edges. It possibly was used as a spindle whorl. These are frequently found at Bossier and Belcher sites, but usually are smaller and lighter.

An additional 46 plain sherds show the wall-base junction. Eight of these are from open flat bowls, one from a deeper bowl, one from a bottle, four from miniature vessels and 32 from jar, deep bowl or cylindrical vessel forms.

The plain sherds have paste characteristics similar to the decorated types already described. Nine of the 644 sherds are bone tempered. 173

Glendora Focus and Other Late Ceramics

A group of 37 sherds have characteristics completely alien to the ceramics described above. They are lighter feeling, often with porous surfaces or with obvious shell tempering, confirmed by tests. Eight are engraved; a shell tempered sherd, reddish in color ([Fig. 10](#), P), with horizontal engraved lines from which triangular spurs project; four other shell tempered with red or orange color and engraved lines, untyped; two black shell tempered with indeterminate engraving, and one black polished clay tempered sherd of type *Hodges Engraved* ([Fig. 10](#), R).

There are 11 sherds, shell tempered and orange to gray in color, with curvilinear incising ([Fig. 10](#), N, S). This ware was once termed *Wilkinson Negative Meander* but was never formally described. Another name should be chosen, because the Wilkinson Site, like Smithport, is primarily Alto with transition to Bossier, and has a minimal late (Natchitoches) occupation.

Two sherds have linear punctations on shell tempered ware ([Fig. 10](#), Q) and two others, untyped, have horizontal incising. There are 14 plain, 4-6 mm. thick, of which nine are shell tempered, two bone, three clay.

Other Pottery Artifacts and Negative Ceramic Traits

A fragment of perforated pottery base, presumably a spindle whorl fragment, was mentioned in the discussion of plain pottery. There were also three fragments of fired daub with grass impressions and one flattened surface. One tiny cone-shaped pottery fragment suggested a figurine or doll leg. No other clay or ceramic artifacts were found. Noticeable by their absence are pipes or pipe stem fragments, animal figurines or heads, clay labrets and ear ornaments, all of which are not unusual in this area.

Other negative ceramic traits are the absence of shell temper, except in the small group of obviously late wares; red filming; pigment impression into the lines of decoration; handles or other vessel appendages; squared bases (not unusual elsewhere in Coles Creek and Alto ceramics); squared or castellated rims (Vessel 105, [Fig. 4](#), I is the only instance of scalloped rim); vessel effigies, either whole vessel or rim attachments; stamping (one foreign sherd), and cord marking.

POTTERY ALIGNMENTS AND SEQUENCES

[Table 1](#) shows the assignment of burial vessel and sherd types to various ceramic complexes, based on the descriptions of Ford (1951), Ford and Willey (1940), and Quimby (1951) for central Louisiana; Newell and Krieger (1949), and Suhm, Krieger, and Jelks (1954) for east Texas Alto; and the author’s publications (1948; 1959) and collections from northern and central Louisiana. It becomes apparent that neat typing and alignment of sherd collections from this site, true of many other sites in northwestern Louisiana, is a phantasy. This site lies within a broad contact zone, extending into southwestern Arkansas and eastern Texas, between the expanding populations and flowering cultures of the lower Mississippi-Red River confluence in central Louisiana and Mississippi on one side and the four-state Caddoan area on the other, in post-Hopewell-Marksville times.

TABLE 1			
Pottery Type or Group			
	<i>Whole Vessels</i>	<i>No. of Sherds</i>	%
Distinctive Alto Types			

<i>Holly Fine Engraved</i>		10	0.66
<i>Hickory Fine Engraved</i>	2	9	0.60
<i>Holly or Hickory Engraved</i>		6	0.40
<i>Carmel Engraved</i>		17	1.13
<i>Davis Incised</i>	1	17	1.13
<i>Kiam Incised vessels</i>	4		
<i>Pennington Punctated-Incised</i>		36	2.40
<i>Pennington-Crockett Hybrid</i>		11	0.73
<i>Weches Fingernail Impressed</i>		19	1.26
<i>Smithport Plain</i>	9	65	4.36
Subtotal	16	190	12.67
Distinctive Coles Creek or Troyville Types			
<i>Coles Creek Incised</i>		8	0.53
<i>Chevalier Stamped</i>		1	0.06
<i>Mazique Incised</i>		2	0.13
Subtotal		11	0.72
Types shared by Alto and Coles Creek			
<i>Wilkinson Punctated</i>	1	153	10.20
Triangular punctations between parallel lines		4	0.26
Subtotal	1	157	10.46
Types shared by Alto, Coles Creek, Bossier and Plaquemine			
<i>Kiam-Hardy Incised</i>		174	11.60
<i>Dunkin-Manchac Incised</i>		182	12.13
<i>Harrison Bayou Incised</i>		9	0.60
<i>Sanson Incised</i>		9	0.60
Free and atypical zoned punctations (<i>Pennington-Rhinehart</i>)	1	38	2.53
Small, zoned punctations (<i>Dupree</i> -like)		6	0.40
Round punctations between lines		7	0.46
Isolated, semilunar punctations		1	0.06
Subtotal	1	426	28.40

Distinctive Bossier Types			
<i>Pease Brushed-Incised</i>		38	2.53
<i>Belcher Ridged</i>		11	0.73
<i>Sinner Linear Punctated</i>		4	0.26
<i>Maddox Engraved</i>		3	0.20
<i>Glassell Engraved</i>		2	0.13
	Subtotal	58	3.86
Types Shared by Bossier and Plaquemine			
<i>Bossier-Plaquemine Brushed</i>		31	2.06
<i>Karnack Brushed-Incised</i>		34	2.26
	Subtotal	65	4.33
Uncertain Affiliation or Untyped			
Curvilinear Incised		2	0.13
Untyped engraved	1	2	0.20
Plain body sherds		579	38.60
Fingernail pinched		8	0.53
	Subtotal	1	591 39.46
	Subtotal, Early Occupation	19	1498 100.00
Late Occupation, Possibly Historic			
Shell tempered curvilinear incised		11	
Shell tempered engraved		7	
<i>Hodges Engraved</i>		1	
Other untyped decorated		4	
Late plain		14	
	Subtotal	37	
	Grand Total	1535	

As a result (or as evidence) of this cultural admixture and interchange, we see large groups of sherds from this site, in the punctated and incised categories, which cannot with impunity be assigned to a previously described type in a specific cultural assemblage. They could be as easily assigned to a companion type in one, two or even three other surrounding assemblages. Only by having whole vessels available—from

which details of vessel size and shape, and decoration can be determined—or by correlation of sherds with distinctive types, may one draw tentative conclusions about affiliation. I have therefore found it necessary ([Table 1](#)) to list certain types from this site as possibly deriving from Alto or Coles Creek ceramics, others from Alto, Coles Creek, Bossier or Plaquemine, and yet a third group of brushed and incised which might derive, insofar as characteristics of a given sherd or group of sherds indicate, from Bossier or Plaquemine. The absence of distinctive Plaquemine types eliminates this assemblage from consideration, but distinctive types of Alto, Coles Creek and Bossier are present and give our clues for major alignments. We should be able to work on the assumption that the indeterminate types will derive from the three complexes, Alto, Coles Creek and Bossier, in about the same proportion as these complexes are represented by distinctive types.

It appears, then, that the major complex at this site is Alto; certainly the burial pottery is of this complex. Coles Creek is present to a minor extent and it is probable that some of the uncertain punctated and incised sherds are from *Hardy*, *Manchac*, and *Rhinehart* types. Finally, occupation seems to have lasted into the Alto-Bossier transition to the stage when distinctive Bossier Focus types had developed, so that there is a respectable representation of this period. The brushed wares and some of the incised and punctated also probably relate to the Bossier pottery complex. It is improbable, however, that Bossier occupation lasted very long, certainly not long enough for a transition to late Glendora Focus times when the small group of shell tempered sherds would have been made. The site was probably deserted for a long time, then briefly occupied by late Natchitoches-related people, possibly in the historic period. The Yatasi village mentioned by Marcelo De Soto (D'Antoni, 1961a) is to be considered.

STONE ARTIFACTS

Dart Points

The 61 larger projectile points which are classified as dart points are, with few exceptions, comparatively small and rough. Most are made of quartzite, cherts, and petrified wood found locally. Thirty-five are of tan

chert, four of petrified wood, two of red chert, six of white or light gray quartzite, and others of varying shades of brown, or mottled materials.

Gary points ([Fig. 11](#), N-P) total 14; with most made of tan chert, two of petrified wood, and one of white quartzite. The range in length is 2.8 to 5.6 cm. with nine of the 14 in the category of *Small Gary* (Ford and Webb, 1956: 52). The latter are less than 4.5 cm. in length.

Ellis points ([Fig. 11](#), Q-S) number 16, of which 12 are made of tan, gray or yellow local cherts, two of petrified wood. The length varies from 2.6 to 4.6 cm., the width 1.5 to 2.9 cm. Shoulders tend to be straight, only two having barbs. Stem bases are usually straight or mildly convex.

Carrollton points ([Fig. 11](#), X), four in number, are made of materials different from the prevailing tan chert. One each is of granular quartzite, waxy gray chert, white chert, and black chert. They are 4.1 to 4.5 cm. long, 2.3 to 2.8 cm. wide. Stems are not smoothed.

Kent points total five ([Fig. 11](#), T, U), and are typically crude in manufacture. They are of gray, tan, and mottled cherts. Lengths are 3.7 cm. to 4.5 cm., widths 1.6 to 2.4 cm.; they are somewhat smaller than those in eastern Texas (Suhm and Jelks, 1962).

The three *Pontchartrain* points ([Fig. 11](#), EE, FF) are the largest and best made points from this site. Two are of light tan chert, the third of darker tan. Lengths are 7.7, 9.3, and 9.7 cm.; widths 2.5, 2.9, and 3.2 cm., respectively. The blades are rounded on one face, ridged on the other, have good large flake scars, and typical fine retouch at the edges. One ([Fig. 11](#), FF) has an asymmetrically placed stem; another ([Fig. 11](#), EE) has a rectangular stem and short barbs; the third has a contracting stem.

One projectile point ([Fig. 11](#), Y) is hesitantly called *Ensor* because of the low, narrow side notches and straight stem base. It is small, 3.7 cm. long and 1.8 cm. wide, of tan chert, roughly flaked. The blade edges are convex and irregular serrated.

Two specimens have outlines like *Desmuke* points but are made of poor materials, petrified wood and gnarled chert, and the typing is questionable.

Both are thick, with bifacial ridges. A third of similar appearance has an *Almagre*-like basal tip, but is much smaller than this type, 5 cm. long, 2.5 cm. wide.

Two points are classified as *Elam* ([Fig. 11](#), V, W). They are short, thick and stubby, slightly asymmetrical and identical in size, 3.5 cm. long, 2.3 cm. wide. They are made of tan and brown quartzite.

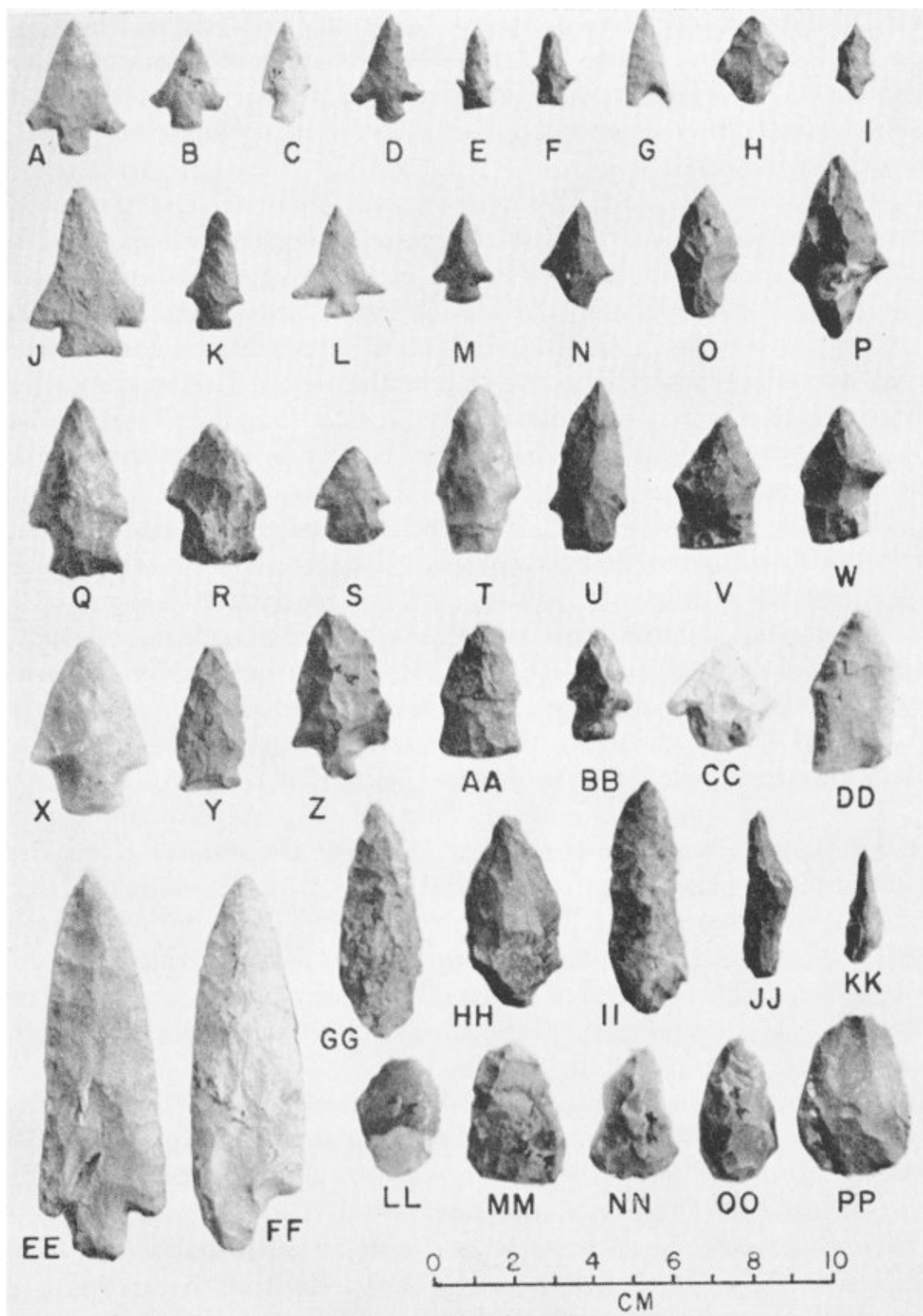


Fig. 11. Projectile Points and Chipped Stone Tools. A, B, *Alba* type. C, D, *Hayes*. E, F, *Friley*. G, *Maud*. H, *Cliffton*. I, Untyped. J, *Catahoula*. K-M, *Colbert*. N-P, *Gary*. Q-S, *Ellis*. T, U, *Kent*. V, W, *Elam*. X, *Carrollton*. Y, possible *Ensor*. Z-DD, Untyped. EE, FF, *Pontchartrain*. GG-II, Rough blades. JJ, KK, Drills. LL, End scraper. MM-PP, Small triangular and ovate scrapers.

Twelve projectile points are unclassified. Three of these are broken. 179 A group of four ([Fig. 11](#), Z) is characterized by rough manufacture, irregular wide blades with poor tips, and small, poorly formed stems. Similar specimens have been found at other sites in north Louisiana, never in large numbers. Possibly they were used as hafted knives or scrapers. One specimen ([Fig. 11](#), AA) has long, shallow side notches which are smoothed and a stubby, poorly made blade. Possibly it is a reworked *Yarbrough* point or an atypical *Trinity* point. A small point of gray quartzite ([Fig. 11](#), BB) has blade edge notches and expanded stem resembling *Evans* points, but it is much smaller than *Evans*. Similar small points with one to several blade edge notches have been found on sites in Bossier and De Soto parishes, they will probably be typed by another name than *Evans* (the name *Sinner* has been suggested because of their frequency at the Jim Sinner Site).

A small point of white chert ([Fig. 11](#), CC) has a greater width than length; the base is wide and short; one shoulder is barbed, the other barely suggested. Another small point has a rectangular stem and triangular blade but is much smaller than *Carrollton*, or even *Elam* points.

The most unusual point ([Fig. 11](#), DD) has a long rectangular stem, a small shoulder on one side only, and a short, asymmetrical blade. Blade and stem edges are beveled bilaterally on each face, with fine retouch flaking which serrates all edges. The base is mildly concave and is thinned by removal of a long, shallow channel flake on one face, a shorter channel flake on the other, terminating in a hinge fracture. The base and lower stem edges are smoothed.

Arrow Points

There are 55 small projectile points sufficiently intact for typing and 12 broken so that typing is impossible. Materials include tan, red, brown, and

gray chert from local gravels; two gray-white chert; one novaculite, and two dark brown to black flint.

Alba points ([Fig. 11](#), A, B), 20 in number, are mostly of tan or reddish-brown local cherts. They vary from slender to wide, with a range of 2 to 3.8 cm. in length. Most recurve to form widened shoulders which may be right angled or barbed; edges may be mildly serrated. I have placed in this type only points with square or rectangular stems.

There are two *Hayes* points ([Fig. 11](#), C, D), of gray and red-brown chert. They are small, 2.6 and 2.8 cm. long, 1.3 and 1.9 cm. wide; the first differs from the type description in having straight edges and no barbs, but the stem shape is typical. 180

Five points are of *Friley* type ([Fig. 11](#), E, F), characterized by definite shoulders with extreme curves so that the barbs turn toward the blade tip. Stems are expanded or rectangular. Three are of red-brown chert, two of tan chert. Lengths are 1.4 to 2.5 cm., widths 1.0 to 1.5 cm.

One typical *Maud* point ([Fig. 11](#), G) of tan chert, has a deeply concave base and mildly serrated edges.

Four points are included in the *Cliffton* type ([Fig. 11](#), H). They are hardly more than roughly shaped small, wide flakes but have vague stems and some secondary flaking. They are uniform in size, 2 to 2.3 cm. long, 1.6 to 1.9 cm. wide and all are made of tan chert. A fifth small point ([Fig. 11](#), I) of dark gray flint has a pointed stem, concave blade edges, and a strongly pointed tip; in essence, it is a concave-edged hexagon. It may be a variation of *Cliffton*, but has been left untyped.

A group of 21 points ([Fig. 11](#), K-M) is characterized by expanded stems produced by corner notching, and blades which are much like *Alba*. This point has been the subject of considerable discussion because of its frequency in Louisiana and southern Arkansas; it has been included in the *Alba* type in some publications, in the *Scallorn* type in others, but has distinct and, we believe, meaningful differences from each of these types. We have therefore given it the type name *Colbert*. It rivals the *Alba* type in frequency at sites like Smithport Landing, Colbert, Greer, Swanson's

Landing, and Mounds Plantation ([Fig. 1](#)) where there are Alto and Coles Creek components in respectable amounts. It is found, along with *Alba*, in central Louisiana, especially in Troyville-Coles Creek context (Ford, 1951: Fig. 45, U-W). Recent excavations at the Crenshaw Site in southwestern Arkansas uncovered Coles Creek and Caddoan burials in Mound B; consistently the Coles Creek burials had points similar to *Colbert* (called *Homan* in Arkansas) and the Caddoan had *Alba* or *Hayes*. The *Colbert* points have triangular blades with concave or recurved edges, distinct and usually wide shoulders, barbs, and triangular or fan-shaped stems. The stem bases may be straight or more often convex, rarely concave. Specimens from Smithport are made of tan, reddish-brown, white and gray local cherts, one of novaculite, and two of white quartz. Lengths are from 1.2 to 3.2 cm., widths from 9 mm. to 2 cm.

A large flat point of tan chert ([Fig. 11](#), J) has the flake characteristics of an arrow point despite its large size, 4.3 by 3 cm. It has the corner notching and wide barbs characteristic of *Catahoula* points.

A small triangular point of brown chert probably belongs to the *Fresno* type. The tip is broken but the original length was about 2 cm.

181

MISCELLANEOUS CHIPPED STONE TOOLS

Generally, the tools from this site are made from native tan chert cores and flakes, or from petrified wood, and are rough to the point of being almost nondescript. Imagination is often required to attempt assignment to types.

A massive axe-shaped object of petrified wood is worked to a near-blade form at the expanded end ([Fig. 12](#), K), but appears to have been used as a maul. The groove is natural. It is 15 cm. long, 9 cm. wide, and 4.5 cm. in thickness. Two smaller objects of petrified wood ([Fig. 12](#), G, H) are partially shaped, showing some of the original surfaces. They resemble choppers or picks and are $7 \times 5.1 \times 2.3$ cm. and $8.8 \times 4.7 \times 2$ cm. A fourth object of petrified wood, 10.5 cm. long and 4.2 cm. wide, is more suggestive of a pick but shows little evidence of use.

Smaller core tools include two choppers or end scrapers of tan chert and quartzite. The first has much of its original surfaces, with one end pointed by bifacial beveling. It is 5.5 cm. long. The second is unifacially beveled across one end and onto one edge; it is similar in size. Two possible gouges of red and tan chert, 3.4 and 4.2 cm. long, are ovate in outline and roughly flaked bifacially at one end. Eight smaller objects are keel-shaped core scrapers or small choppers of tan and gray chert. They are irregularly ovate, triangular or elongate, from 2.5 to 4 cm. in length, 1.8 to 3.3 cm. in width. Flaking is bifacial but those with one flat face have minimal flaking on this side. Two larger, thick leaf-shaped forms ([Fig. 11](#), GG, HH) may have served as knives or scrapers.

Other tools are made from flakes. Two might be knives: one ([Fig. 11](#), II) is of gray chert, long and ovoid, rough at the base but well finished around the edges. It is 5.9 cm. long, 2 cm. wide. The second is made from a flat, triangular-shaped piece of petrified wood, which is unmodified at one end (the base), but has good secondary flaking around the edges. It is 5.1 cm. long, 3 cm. wide, and 6 mm. in thickness.

A thumbnail end scraper ([Fig. 11](#), LL) is of gray quartz, 3 × 2 cm. in diameters, 6 mm. thick. Unifacial beveling on one end and one side is quite steep and the reverse face shows many tiny fractures around the cutting curve.

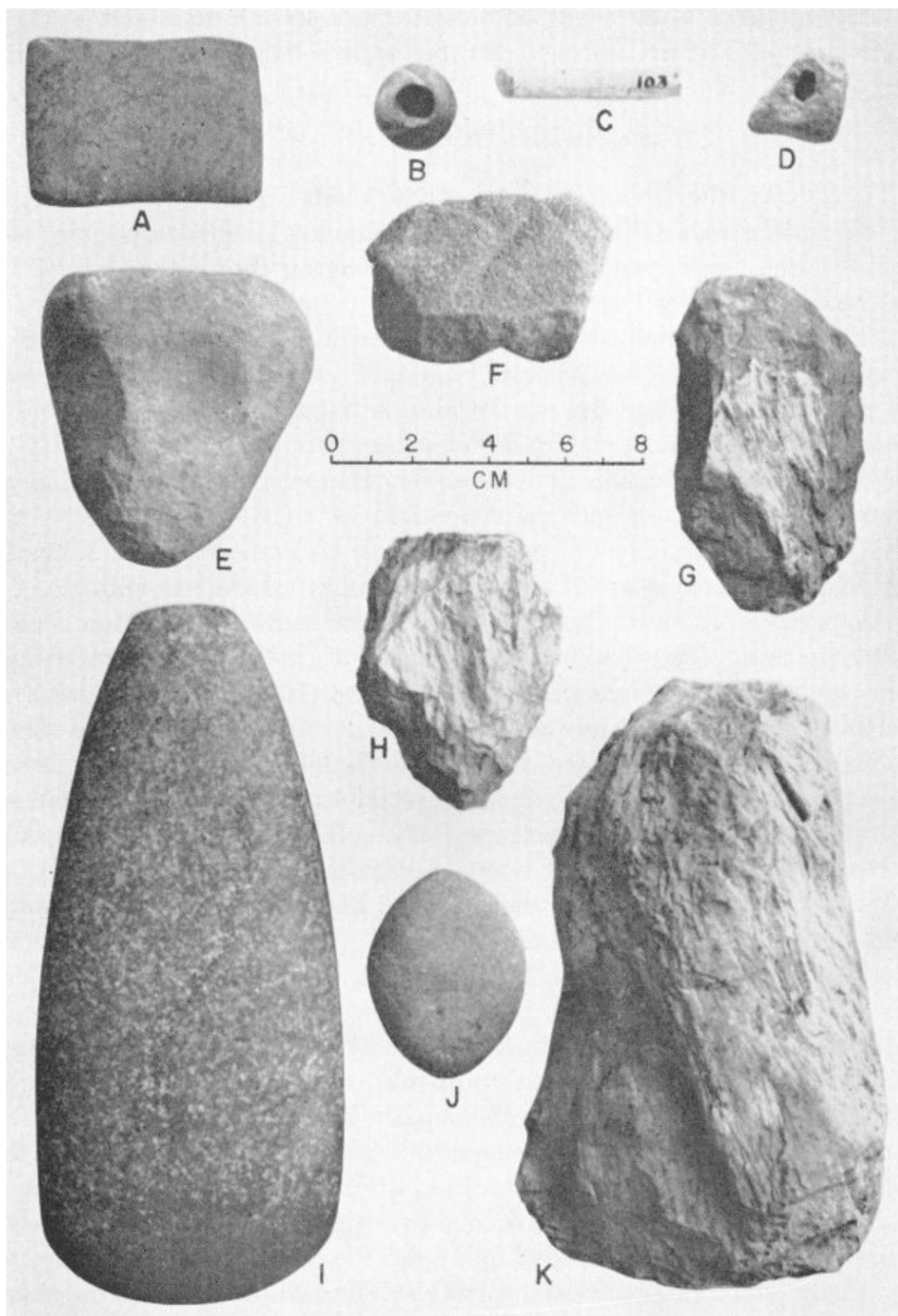


Fig. 12. Ornaments and Stone Tools. A, Polished stone tablet. B, Banded slate bead. C, Bone bead. D, Sandstone bead or concretion. E, Pitted stone. F, Brown sandstone whetstone. G, H, Choppers of petrified wood. I, Polished stone celt. J, Small hammerstone. K, Maul of petrified wood. (All to scale except B, C and D which are only slightly reduced.)

There are 15 small scrapers ([Fig. 11](#), MM-PP) which are ovate or triangular in outline and made from flakes which vary from 3 to 8 mm. in thickness. They are of tan, brown and mottled gray chert, petrified wood, and gray quartzite. Most are flaked bifacially but some show a preponderance of flaking on the convex face. Sizes range from 2 to 4.5 cm. Five small broken flake objects show some flaking.

There are four drills, all made of tan chert. One flake drill ([Fig. 11](#), KK) has an expanded base, a shaft which is triangular in cross section and a keen point which shows use polish. A second ([Fig. 11](#), JJ) has a geniculate form, is less well made, but shows usage at the tip. The other two are tiny, 2.1 and 2.2 cm. long, have one flat and one keel-shaped face, and are worked on two of the three planes. They could have been used as gravers or drills.

POLISHED AND GROUND STONE OBJECTS

Few objects of polished stone were found. One large celt ([Fig. 12](#), I) is from the surface. It is symmetrically ovate, 17.5 cm. long, 7.5 cm. wide, and 3.8 cm. thick. It shows pecking marks on the faces, but is well ground at the bit and along the edges. A triangular hard sandstone pebble, $7.5 \times 7 \times 3.3$ cm., has round pits, 3 cm. in diameter, on each face, ([Fig. 12](#), E). There are smooth depressions on two edges. A large pitted mortar stone is of ferruginous sandstone, 22×16 cm. One face has an oval depression, 13×12 cm., in the center of which, and on the opposite face, are deep hemispherical pits, 3.5 cm. in diameter.

An oval-shaped hammerstone ([Fig. 12](#), J) of tan chert is smoothed on two faces, roughened by pecking around all edges. A whetstone of brown sandstone ([Fig. 12](#), F) has one deep and two shallow grooves on one face, two grooves on the opposite.

A rectangular flat tablet of mottled brown slate ([Fig. 12](#), A) was found during the burial excavations but not in direct association. It is 6 cm. long, 4.5 cm. wide, and 3.5 mm. thick. The faces are polished and the edges ground smooth with rounded corners, but there are no decorations or perforations.

A bead of gray and brown banded slate ([Fig. 12](#), B) was found on the surface of Hill 1. It is pear-shaped, 9 mm. long, 12 mm. wide, counter-drilled and highly polished. A small perforated sandstone concretion ([Fig. 12](#), D) may have been used as a bead, but the perforation seems to be natural, and the surfaces are not modified.

An oval, reddish claystone concretion was found on the surface. It is 12 × 6.5 cm., and 2.7 cm. thick. The hard cortex had been removed, exposing the soft ocher, which was a probable source of paint.

BONE OBJECT

A segment of bone, 2.6 cm. long, was found on the surface. The ends are cut squarely across and there is a small (natural?) perforation. It is probably a bead of bird bone ([Fig. 12](#), C), is hard, very white, and the surface is polished. No other artifacts of bone or shell were found, but the test pits in dark soil exposed numerous animal bones as well as mussel and snail shells. No identifications were secured.

DISCUSSION

The Smithport Landing Site is one of a number of village and mound sites along the Red River valley and its tributaries in northwestern Louisiana ([Fig. 1](#)) at which varying amounts of Alto Focus pottery, whole vessels or sherds, have been found. The mound sites shown are within the river flood plain, with exception of Thigpen Mound and Village Site, which are on a terrace immediately overlooking the valley; Gahagan, Curtis, Mounds Plantation, and Belcher mounds are on old river channels near the present stream. The burial vessels at Gahagan were Alto types—five *Holly Fine Engraved*, three *Hickory Engraved*, one *Kiam Incised*—and 12% of the 76

sherds from the surface are the distinctive Alto types (*Hickory*, *Carmel* and *Holly Engraved*, *Davis Incised*, *Crockett Curvilinear Incised*, *Weches Fingernail Impressed* and *Pennington Punctated-Incised*). The Thigpen Site is preponderantly Bossier, but included in the scant collection of 102 sherds are one *Weches*, five *Dunkin*, and five *Wilkinson*. We have only a few sherds from the Curtis Mound (Sunny Point in Moore's 1912 report) but *Hickory Fine Engraved* is included. At the Belcher Mound Site (Webb, 1959) the premound level had sherds and burial vessels of both Alto and Haley types.

The Mounds Plantation (Pickett Landing in Moore's 1912 report) Site has recently been explored with some intensity (McKinney, Plants and Webb, to be reported). Twenty-six percent of the decorated sherds in the previous surface collection were of the distinctive Alto types, 4.15% Coles Creek. A trench through one of the mounds showed intrusive Belcher Focus burials but the fill, habitation, and premound level sherds were Coles Creek and Alto, with admixture at all levels but increasing amounts of Alto in the top levels. Alto types are *Davis* and *Harrison Bayou Incised*; *Hickory*, *Holly* and *Carmel Engraved*; *Pennington*, *Crockett*, *Wilkinson*, and *Weches* in the punctated and punctated-incised categories. Coles Creek types were *Coles Creek*, *Chase* and *Beldeau Incised*; *Rhinehart Punctated*; and the shared types *Hardy* and *Sanson Incised*. Deep burials in a second mound had scant pottery but the two vessels were *Holly Engraved* and a bowl with *Crockett* and *Pennington* designs, both black and polished.

185

The non-mound village sites shown in [Figure 1](#) are on hills fronting the valley or on tributaries and lakes. All of those shown have Alto and Bossier pottery types, most have Coles Creek-Troyville, all have a good representation of the shared types *Hardy-Kiam*, *Dunkin-Manchac*, *Harrison Bayou* and *Sanson Incised*, *Wilkinson Punctated*, and *Rhinehart-atypical*, *Pennington Punctated-Incised*. Omitting these shared types and using only distinctive types, the Allen Site has 7% Alto, no Coles Creek; the Wilkinson Site has 10.5% Alto, 0.3% Coles Creek; the Chamarre Site has 14% Alto, 1.5% Troyville; Williams Point has 4% Alto, no Coles Creek; East Smithport has 8% Alto, no Coles Creek; the Colbert Place has 1.6% Alto, 5.45% Coles Creek; Greer has 6.7% Alto, 1.8% Coles Creek; Pease and Sinner are strong Bossier sites but have 0.3% and 0.5% Alto, respectively;

Swanson's Landing has 4% Alto and 4% Coles Creek; and Harrison Bayou has 1% Alto.

Not all of the mound or village sites in this same area show this kind of representation of Alto or Coles Creek; there are as many or more which are well developed Bossier sites and have little or no Alto. For example, we have 230 surface sherds from the Vanceville Mound in Bossier Parish with no Alto or Coles Creek types; the 3942 sherds from the lower and premound levels of the Oden Mound include two questionable *Hickory Engraved*, no other Alto or Coles Creek types; 1275 surface sherds from the Marston Village Site show no Coles Creek, one *Holly Fine Engraved*, and three *Pennington Punctated-Incised*. In these same sites, as the distinctive types drop out, the shared incised and punctated types like *Dunkin-Manchac*, *Rhinehart-Pennington* variants, *Wilkinson*, *Harrison Bayou Incised* and even *Hardy-Kiam Incised* are almost completely replaced by *Pease Brushed-Incised*, *Belcher Ridged*, and the brushed types (Webb, 1959). Large projectile points and heavy scraper types also disappear, replaced by small arrow point types and thumbnail-size, triangular and rectangular flake scrapers (Webb, 1959: Fig. 126).

The Smithport Landing Site shares with the other hilltop or hill slope village sites of this earlier Caddoan period the carry-over of late Archaic dart points, especially types like *Gary*, *Ellis*, *Kent*, *Carrollton*, *Palmillas*, *San Patrice*, *Evans*, *Maçon*, and *Pontchartrain*. Large as well as small scrapers, pitted stones, manos of hand size, oval metates, small drills, large and small celts, brown and white sandstone hones, hammerstones, and crude choppers are usual at these sites. Triangular and ovate knives, recurved-edge (*Copena*-like) knives, stone beads and polished stone problematics (boatstones, bannerstones, gorgets) or plummets are all missing or very rare, although stone beads and problematics occur in the late Archaic. The slate bead from Smithport, a recurved (*Copena*) blade fragment from the Thigpen Site, and a two-hole gorget from a small site north of Wallace Lake (Webb, 1948: Pl. 16, 9) are exceptions. Small projectile points, generally of *Alba* and *Colbert* types, about equal the number of large ones at these sites. Ear ornaments, shell and bone tools are infrequent.

In conclusion, the Smithport Landing Site is one of the larger village sites of the earlier Caddoan (Gibson Aspect, Alto Focus) period along the Red River valley in northwestern Louisiana. It shares with a number of other village sites of this period evidences of a carry over of late Archaic projectile points and stone artifact traits. It also shares with numerous village and mound sites evidences of admixture of Coles Creek ceramic types and influences with the Alto pottery types as the earliest pottery at these sites. It seems increasingly clear that the advent of Coles Creek and Alto Caddoan peoples and/or ceramics, arrow points, and riverine mound building into this area were virtually simultaneous occurrences. Out of this blending developed the subsequent Bossier Focus ceramics and other cultural manifestations over a wide portion of northwestern Louisiana, extending into eastern Texas and southern Arkansas.

It is possible that the large ceremonial mound groups, like Gahagan and Mounds Plantation, served as ceremonial centers for a number of villages, including those in the adjoining hill areas, accounting for the frequency of specialized burials, with ceremonial copper and polished stone objects, pipes and ornamentation, and highly developed burial ceramics, in the mound sites, in comparison with the paucity of these objects in the hill villages.

Considerable research is needed (1) to establish the nature of the relationships between mound sites in the valleys and the villages in the hills; (2) to trace the extent of Coles Creek and Alto contacts and the process of amalgamation of these two strong cultures over the wide area from central Louisiana into Arkansas, Oklahoma and eastern Texas (this must have been friendly, as it is inconceivable that Caddoan peoples would have supplanted Coles Creek almost overnight in hundreds of villages); (3) and the development out of this amalgamation of Bossier, Plaquemine, and other later cultures.

FOOTNOTES

- [1] Thanks are extended to Monroe Dodd, Jr., George Freeman, and other friends who assisted in the site exploration; to Alex Krieger and James

A. Ford for assistance with pottery identification and typology; to A. L. Wedgeworth, Jr., for photography; and to Gordon Maxcy for film developing and assistance with the plates.

REFERENCES CITED

D'Antoni, Blaise C.

1961a. Bayou Pierre, Land of Yesteryear, Chapter 2. Newsletter, North Louisiana Historical Assn., April, pp. 9-14.

1961b. Bayou Pierre, Land of Yesteryear, Chapter 3. Newsletter, North Louisiana Historical Assn., July, pp. 7-12.

1962. Bayou Pierre, Land of Yesteryear, Chapter 5. Newsletter, North Louisiana Historical Assn., May, pp. 13-15.

Ford, James A.

1951. Greenhouse: A Troyville-Coles Creek Period Site in Avoyelles Parish, Louisiana. Anthropological Papers of the American Museum of Natural History, Vol. 44, Part 1.

Ford, James A., and Clarence H. Webb

1956. Poverty Point, A Late Archaic Site in Louisiana. Anthropological Papers of the American Museum of Natural History, Vol. 46, Part 1.

Ford, James A., and G. R. Willey

1940. Crooks Site, A Marksville Period Burial Mound in La Salle Parish, Louisiana. Department of Conservation, Louisiana Geological Survey, Anthropological Study No. 3.

Moore, Clarence B.

1912. Some Aboriginal Sites on Red River. Journal of the Academy of Natural Sciences of Philadelphia, 2nd. Series, Vol. 14, Part 4.

Newell, H. Perry, and Alex D. Krieger

1949. The George C. Davis Site, Cherokee County, Texas. Memoirs of the Society for American Archaeology, No. 5.

Quimby, George I.

1951. The Medora Site, West Baton Rouge Parish, Louisiana. Field Museum of Natural History, Anthropological Series, Vol. 24, No. 2.

1957. The Bayou Goula Site, Iberville Parish, Louisiana. Fieldiana: Anthropology, Vol. 47, No. 2.

Suhm, Dee Ann, Alex D. Krieger, and Edward B. Jelks

1954. An Introductory Handbook of Texas Archeology. Bulletin of the Texas Archeological Society, Vol. 25.

Suhm, Dee Ann, and Edward B. Jelks (editors)

1962. Handbook of Texas Archeology: Type Descriptions. The Texas Archeological Society, Special Publication No. 1, and The Texas Memorial Museum Bulletin, No. 4.

Webb, Clarence H.

1948. Caddoan Prehistory: The Bossier Focus. Bulletin of the Texas Archeological and Paleontological Society, Vol. 19.

1959. The Belcher Mound, A Stratified Caddoan Site in Caddo Parish, Louisiana. Memoirs of the Society for American Archaeology, No. 16.

1961. Relationships between the Caddoan and Central Louisiana Culture Sequences. Bulletin of the Texas Archeological Society, Vol. 31.

1560 Line Avenue
Shreveport, Louisiana

Transcriber's Notes

- Silently corrected a few typos.
- Retained publication information from the printed edition: this eBook is public-domain in the country of publication.
- In the text versions only, text in italics is delimited by _underscores_.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE SMITHPORT
LANDING SITE: AN ALTO FOCUS COMPONENT IN DE SOTO
PARISH, LOUISIANA ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.